Monetary Policy Transmission and Building Land Scarcity: A Panel Local Projections Analysis of Regional Austrian Housing Markets

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Abstract

Acknowledgements

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1. Introduction

1.1. Motivation

In the period after the global financial crisis, the European Central Bank employed several monetary policy tools beyond the conventional adjustment of the policy rate. The subsequent years of Euro Area monetary policy are characterized first by large-scale asset purchases and later by rapid monetary tightening (Benigno et al., 2023). Over the same period, residential property prices in Austria increased significantly through 2021 and then corrected from 2022 onward, tracking the broad development of monetary conditions (Belabed et al., 2022; Hildebrandt et al., 2023). While the transmission mechanism of monetary policy to residential real estate prices is by now well documented, there is a strand of literature that argues that such effects are heterogeneous across regional housing markets.

Local supply conditions are crucial. In regions where the local housing stock can expand readily, a demand impulse can be absorbed through new construction, whereas in regions where developable land is scarce, such an impulse is absorbed through prices (Aastveit & Anundsen, 2022; Saiz, 2010). Austria, with its pronounced geographic variation in the availability of building land, is a natural setting in which to examine this mechanism. The regional transmission of monetary policy to housing within the Euro Area has so far been traced to the structure of mortgage finance rather than to supply conditions (Battistini et al., 2025). The interaction between monetary policy, supply elasticities, and structural features of regional housing markets highlights the relevance of a regional analysis when assessing effects of ECB policy in Austria. While the theoretical and institutional framework establish the link of supply constraints to price dynamics, the differential impact of monetary policy shocks on regional Austrian housing markets has not been empirically isolated. This is precisely the research gap this thesis addresses.

1.2. Research Question and Contribution

The primary objective of this thesis is to examine the moderating role of regional supply elasticity in the transmission of Euro Area monetary policy to residential real estate prices in Austrian districts. The central aim is to analyze whether regional housing mar-

kets exhibit systematic heterogeneity driven by structural supply constraints, motivating the primary research question.

Research Question *To what extent do local supply constraints moderate the dynamic response of district-level residential real estate prices to ECB monetary policy shocks in Austria?*

The primary research question is examined along three dimensions, which the empirical analysis addresses in turn.

Sub-question 1 *Does a monetary easing surprise raise district-level real estate prices by more in supply-inelastic than in supply-elastic districts?*

Sub-question 2 *Does any such differential response hold or fade over the three-year horizon following the shock?*

Sub-question 3 *Does the moderating role of supply constraints differ between the easing and tightening monetary policy surprises?*

To answer these questions, this thesis employs a quarterly panel of Austrian districts and estimates panel local projections (Jordà, 2005) in which high-frequency ECB monetary policy surprises (Altavilla et al., 2019) are interacted with a district-level classification of supply constraints based on the local scarcity of developable land. Its contribution is to provide district-level evidence for Austria on the supply side of monetary policy transmission to housing, joining a mechanism established for the United States (Aastveit & Anundsen, 2022) with a regional dimension that existing Euro Area studies have addressed through the structure of mortgage finance (Battistini et al., 2025).

The remainder of the thesis is organized as follows. Chapter 2 examines the economic and institutional framework of Euro Area monetary policy and Austrian housing markets. Chapter 3 reviews the literature on monetary policy transmission to housing and the moderating role of supply constraints, and develops the testable hypotheses that correspond to the research questions above. Chapter 4 describes the data and the construction of the panel, Chapter 5 the empirical strategy, and Chapter 6 the results. Chapter 7 discusses the findings considering the literature and answers the research questions, and Chapter 8 concludes.

2. Institutional and Economic Background

This chapter sets out the economic and institutional background against which the empirical analysis is carried out. It first describes the monetary policy environment of the Euro Area over the relevant period. It then turns to the Austrian housing market, tracing the long rise in residential prices and its recent correction, the accompanying deterioration in affordability and the role of credit conditions, and finally the structural differences across Austrian districts in the availability of building land. Together these strands motivate the central concern of the thesis, namely that a common monetary impulse doesn't necessarily reach every regional housing market in the same way when the local capacity to supply new housing differs. The evidence assembled here is drawn from external sources and remains descriptive.

2.1. ECB Monetary Policy Context

The monetary policy environment over the period studied in this thesis was shaped less by movements in the policy rate than by a sequence of unconventional measures. As the policy rate approached its effective lower bound in the years after the global financial crisis, the ECB turned to instruments that operated directly on longer-term interest rates (Benigno et al., 2023). The centerpiece was the asset purchase program (APP) launched in 2015, under which the Eurosystem bought public and private sector securities on a large scale in order to compress term premia and ease financing conditions along the yield curve (European Central Bank, 2026b). Because these purchases worked by absorbing duration risk rather than by moving the overnight rate, their transmission ran through the long end of the curve (Eser et al., 2019), which is the segment most relevant for the valuation of a long-lived asset such as housing.

The onset of the COVID-19 pandemic prompted a further and larger round of purchases. In March 2020, the ECB introduced the pandemic emergency purchase program (PEPP), a temporary and flexible envelope that was expanded in December 2020 to a total of € 1 850 billion and extended into 2022 (European Central Bank, 2020, 2026a). The direction of policy then reversed sharply. As inflation rose, net asset purchases were wound down over the first half of 2022 and the ECB began raising its key interest rates in July 2022, moving from negative territory to positive rates over the following year

(European Central Bank, 2022). Within a short span the euro area thus passed from aggressive easing through unconventional means to a rapid conventional tightening.

This sequence matters for the identification strategy of this thesis in two ways. First, the succession of easing and tightening periods generates pronounced variation in monetary conditions within a relatively short window, which is what makes it possible to trace the response of real estate prices to policy surprises. Second, because the dominant impulses operated on long-term rates rather than on the overnight rate, the appropriate measure of the monetary shock is one taken at a long maturity, a choice developed in the empirical strategy of this thesis. These phases also provide the background for the developments in the Austrian housing market taken up in the following subsections.

2.2. The Austrian Residential Real Estate Market

Residential property prices in Austria have followed a long upward trajectory that began well before the period examined in this thesis, as Figure 1 shows. Prices rose sharply from around 2005, most pronounced in Vienna but outside the capital as well. By the early part of the following decade, the increase had prompted considerations about whether it remained justified by fundamentals (Schneider, 2013). Assessing the market using a composite indicator that compares observed prices against a range of fundamental factors, such as affordability relative to household borrowing capacity, the ratio of prices to rents, and the relation of prices to construction costs, Schneider (2013) found signs of growing overvaluation in Vienna while the market for Austria as a whole still appeared broadly in line with, or slightly below, its fundamental level. Already at this stage the national figure concealed a marked divergence between the capital and the rest of the country, the sources of which are taken up in Section 2.4.

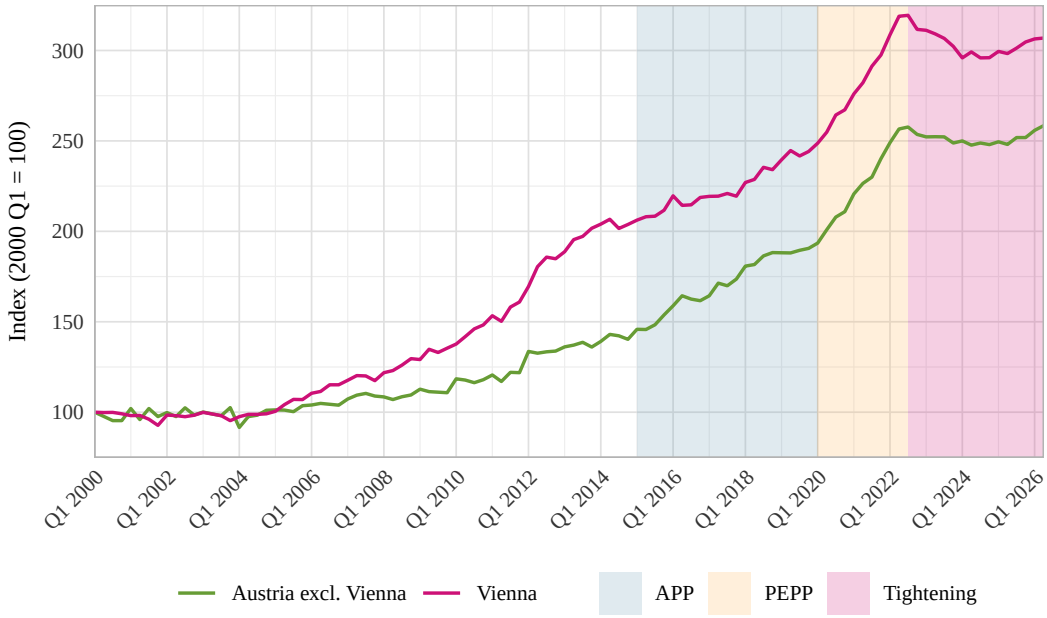


Figure 1: Austrian residential property prices
Residential property price index: Q1 2000 = 100. Shaded areas: asset purchase program (APP), pandemic emergency purchase program (PEPP), tightening cycle. Source: OeNB - Österreichische Nationalbank (2026e).

The upward trend steepened after 2020. Through 2021 residential price growth in Austria ran above 10% y-o-y, reaching a peak of 12.6% in Q4 2021, with prices outside Vienna rising even faster than in the capital (Belabed et al., 2022). The acceleration was accompanied by a rising degree of estimated overvaluation, and by supply-side pressures particular to the pandemic, as shortages of materials and higher construction costs constrained the completion of new housing and added to the pressure on prices (Belabed et al., 2022). The combination of expanding demand under low financing costs and a constrained supply response is precisely the configuration in which a demand impulse feeds into prices rather than quantities.

The turn came in 2022. As financing conditions tightened over the course of the year, price growth slowed abruptly, and residential prices recorded their first quarterly decline in several years at the end of 2022 before stagnating into early 2023, when year-on-year growth fell to around 1% (Hildebrandt et al., 2023). The correction reflected the sharp increase in financing costs and heightened uncertainty households were facing (Hildebrandt et al., 2023). One feature of this longer arc is worth carrying forward.

The most pronounced movements in Austrian house prices, both the acceleration and its reversal, extend beyond the window for which consistent district-level data are available, so that the panel used in this thesis captures only part of the full cycle. This constraint on the observable period is a limitation to which the discussion returns.

2.3. Affordability and Credit Conditions

The prolonged rise in prices described above did not occur against comparably rising incomes, and the result has been a persistent deterioration in housing affordability. Comparing housing costs with wage levels across a set of Central European cities, Matějková and Tichá (2025) find that affordability is shaped by the interaction of wage dynamics, supply constraints, migration pressures, and policy, rather than by prices alone. Within that comparison Vienna occupies a relatively favorable position, owing more to higher average incomes than to moderate prices, which suggests that affordability in Austria is a structural feature of the market rather than a transient consequence of any single phase of monetary policy. The same conclusion emerges from the observation that price increases in the most dynamic urban markets have consistently outpaced the growth of household incomes (Mundt et al., 2024).

The strain is unevenly distributed across households and regions. Examining homeownership among young adults, Mundt et al. (2024) document a decline since 2010 that is more pronounced in urban markets, where the gap between prices and incomes is widest, and they argue that a purely national reading of affordability obscures large differences between regions and between dwelling types. They interpret the retreat from ownership among younger cohorts as a deepening problem of intergenerational equity, and they conclude that demand-side subsidies have not reached the scale required to counteract the underlying market trend, pointing instead to the expansion of housing supply as the more effective lever. This diagnosis places the availability of land and new construction, rather than the terms of finance alone, at the center of the affordability question.

Credit conditions nonetheless shaped the cycle in an important way, as Figure 2 illustrates. Over the low-rate years, housing loan growth was robust and dominated by long-term lending, with loans of a maturity beyond five years accounting for the large majority of outstanding housing credit (Belabed et al., 2022). While the maturity of a housing loan determines the length of the contract, the transmission of a change in

the policy rate to borrowers depends on the period over which the interest rate is fixed. Figure 3 documents a marked change in the fixation structure of new housing loans over the past two decades. The share of loans with a variable rate or an initial rate fixation of up to one year rose from about 47% of new housing loans in 2003 to about 84% in 2014, before loans with a fixation period of more than five years increased to about 55% of new lending by 2022 (OeNB - Österreichische Nationalbank, 2026c). Since a considerable part of the outstanding stock originated in the period of predominantly variable lending, the rate increases of 2022 are likely to have been passed through to a substantial share of existing borrowers, whereas more recent loans with longer fixation periods were affected to a lesser extent. When financing costs rose sharply from 2022, the effect on new lending was immediate, as the interest rate on new housing loans climbed steeply and the growth of the outstanding stock of household housing loans fell from its 2021 pace, turning negative in 2023 and 2024 (Hildebrandt et al., 2023; OeNB - Österreichische Nationalbank, 2026b, 2026d). This weakening of credit and the accompanying decline in demand contributed to the price correction already described. The affordability and credit conditions described here operate on the demand side of the market, and they form the counterpart to the supply-side differences among Austrian districts examined next.



Figure 2: Housing credit to private households
Bars: growth of the outstanding stock of housing loans to private households (% y-o-y); Line: average interest rate on new housing loans (%, right axis). Source: OeNB - Österreichische Nationalbank (2026b, 2026d).

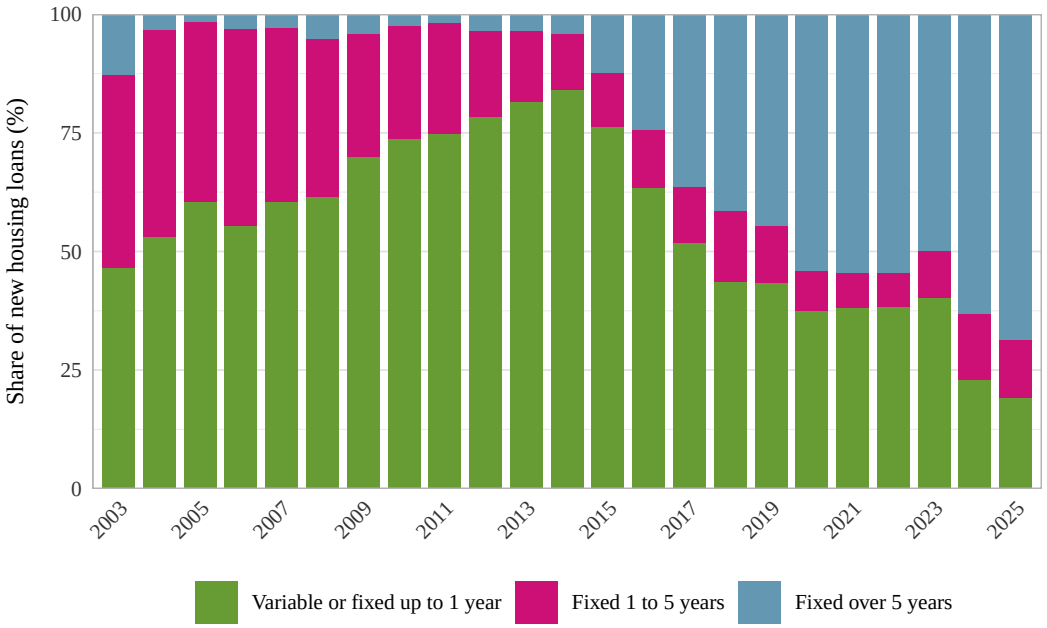


Figure 3: New housing loans to private households by initial rate fixation
Share of new-business volume by initial period of rate fixation, calendar-year totals. Source: OeNB - Österreichische Nationalbank (2026c).

2.4. Regional Housing Market Heterogeneity

The starting point for a district-level analysis is that the land on which housing is built is scarce in Austria and unevenly distributed. Only about 39% of Austria's territory is permanent settlement area, the land physically available for settlement, agriculture, and transport, and a substantial share of that is already in use (ÖROK Monitoring of Building Land Reserves, 2025b). This scarcity is closely tied to topography. The Alps cover the majority of the country, and Alpine regions offer far less developable land than the hilly landscapes of the east, where large-scale agriculture and urban expansion are possible (Schindelegger & Seher, 2025). The constraint can be severe at the local level. The municipality of Sölden, for instance, extends over a larger area than the city of Vienna, yet only around 1.2% of its territory is suitable for development (Schindelegger & Seher, 2025). Because these limits are set by terrain and natural hazards, they are a predetermined feature of a district rather than something that adjusts as demand changes.

This geographic variation is reflected directly in land markets. Average building-land

prices differ enormously across Austrian districts, with the ratio between the most and least expensive districts far wider for land than for dwellings, and they follow a pronounced west-east gradient, with urban agglomerations and tourism-intensive regions at the top and the eastern and southeastern periphery at the bottom (Reiner & Musil, 2023). In tourism-dependent districts the scarcity is compounded by competing claims on land, since the revenue attainable from commercial accommodation and secondary homes tends to exceed that from local residential use, which increases prices and crowds out housing for residents (Schindelegger & Seher, 2025). Institutional arrangements add a further layer of variation, as zoning and the allocation of building land rest largely with municipalities, whose planning decisions and willingness to mobilize land differ locally (Schindelegger & Seher, 2025).

Against these differences in supply, demand pressure is itself regionally concentrated. Population growth and household formation have been strongest in urban and peri-urban areas, precisely where developable land is most constrained, and the price dynamics that follow have outpaced income growth most clearly there (Mundt et al., 2024). A national reading of the housing market averages over these opposing conditions and conceals them. The districts of Austria therefore differ not only in their price levels but in the structural capacity of their local housing stock to expand, and it is this predetermined, geographically rooted variation in the availability of building land that the empirical analysis of this thesis uses to distinguish supply-inelastic from supply-elastic markets.

3. Literature Review: Theory and Hypotheses

The following chapter positions this thesis within the literature on the transmission of monetary policy to real estate prices and the central mechanism addressed in the empirical design. The first subsection examines the channel through which monetary policy reaches real estate prices and the structural features that govern its strength. The second turns to the mechanism at the center of this thesis, the way local supply constraints shape both the size and the sign of the price response, and reviews the United States and Euro Area evidence on which it rests. The third subsection addresses previous research for Austria specifically, and the fourth formulates the preceding threads together into the research gap and the testable hypotheses that guide the empirical analysis.

3.1. Monetary Policy and Housing Prices

Any account of how monetary policy reaches real estate prices begins from the durability of the asset. Poterba (1984) formalizes the owner-occupied housing market as an asset market in which a rational buyer equates the price of a dwelling with the present discounted value of the stream of housing services it is expected to yield. In this framework the price is governed by the user cost of holding housing capital. User cost combines the required return, the tax treatment of ownership, and expected appreciation. Any factor altering the rate at which future service flows are discounted therefore affects the price today. Two features of Poterbas (1984) model recur later in this thesis. First, the responsiveness of the price to a given change in the user cost is not constant, but depends on the expected future path of construction, since the marginal value of housing services falls as the stock expands. Where new supply is expected to arrive quickly, a demand impulse is absorbed in quantities rather than prices, and where it is not, the impulse capitalizes into the price. Second, because the relevant discount rate applies to a long horizon, it is movements in longer-term interest rates, that matter most for valuation. The first feature anticipates the role of supply elasticity developed in Section 3.2; the second motivates the use of a long-maturity interest rate as the monetary impulse relevant for housing.

Empirical work confirms that this channel is active and that its strength varies systematically with structural features of the market. Di Casola and Grothe (2026) quantify the transmission of monetary policy to consumption through housing across 20 advanced economies. They find that the peak response of house prices to a policy shock is itself heterogeneous across countries, and that this heterogeneity lines up with characteristics such as the home-ownership rate, household indebtedness, and the prevalence of adjustable-rate mortgages. Their result that the sensitivity of the price response depends on structural housing-market traits is motivation for the logic this thesis pursues at the district level, with local supply conditions in place of national mortgage structures. The fact that house-price movements matter for the wider economy is documented by Cevik and Naik (2023), who estimate for a panel of European countries that a fall in real house prices measurably dampens consumer spending over the following two years. For Austria the evidence suggests caution about the magnitude of this feedback. Using household survey data, Albacete and Lindner (2017) find a wealth effect on consumption that is statistically present but small, and one carried more by financial assets than by

housing. The Austrian wealth channel is therefore genuine but limited, which is one reason this thesis takes the differential price response itself as the object of interest.

A distinct strand of literature examines how demand-side behavior shapes the transmission, and it bears directly on the property-composition argument taken up in Section 4. Biljanovska et al. (2025) estimate, in an instrumental-variable local projection framework on United States metropolitan areas, that house prices respond more strongly to a policy rate change where housing is overvalued, with a one-standard-deviation higher price-to-rent ratio associated with an additional decline of roughly one percentage point in real prices three years after monetary tightening. They attribute this dependence to extrapolative beliefs, in which investors extend recent price trends into their expectations and are later disappointed by reversals, and they show that it is the investor segment, proxied by non-owner-occupied purchases, whose demand contracts most sharply after tightening. This mechanism supplies a behavioral reason to expect that markets dominated by investor rather than owner-occupier demand transmit monetary policy differently, a point that becomes relevant once the Austrian districts are shown to differ markedly in their tenure and property composition.

Finally, much of the monetary impulse over the sample period arrived through unconventional policy, which reinforces the focus on long-term rates. Eser et al. (2019) trace the Euro Area asset purchase program through an arbitrage-free term-structure model, in which the purchases absorb duration risk from price-sensitive investors and thereby compress the term premium on euro-area sovereign bonds. On this basis they estimate that the program lowered the ten-year euro-area sovereign term premium by around 95 basis points, a reduction that faded only slowly. Because the program operated directly on the long end of the curve, its transmission to housing runs through the same discounting channel as conventional policy, only reached by a different instrument. Benigno et al. (2023) reach a similar conclusion in their survey of the theory and evidence on the program. Unconventional policy also reaches real estate through bank balance sheets. Berg et al. (2024) study the ECB's corporate bond purchases in Germany, a market where firms faced few credit-supply frictions, and find that the freed-up lending capacity was reallocated toward real estate, raising property prices and overvaluation with attendant financial-stability risks. To the extent that Austria, like Germany, was not among the credit-constrained economies of the euro-area periphery over this period, this credit-reallocation channel plausibly operated alongside the discounting channel. Taken

together, the literature establishes that conventional and unconventional monetary policy alike reach real estate prices through long-term interest rates, and that the strength of the response depends on structural and behavioral features of the local market, both of which motivate the design pursued in the remainder of this thesis.

3.2. Housing Supply Constraints and Monetary Policy Transmission

Whether a change in the cost of capital raises real estate prices or instead translates to new construction depends on how the local housing stock can expand. This is the mechanism that motivates this thesis, and it rests on a body of work that treats the responsiveness of supply as a structural market feature rather than a choice that adjusts freely with demand. Saiz (2010) gives this idea empirical content by estimating the amount of developable land in United States metropolitan areas from satellite measures of terrain and water. Saiz (2010) shows that housing supply elasticity is well described as a function of both physical geography and regulatory constraints. Areas hemmed in by steep terrain or water are precisely those in which supply is least able to accommodate demand, so that a demand impulse is absorbed in prices rather than in quantities. The land scarcity that Austrian districts inherit from their geography is the same kind of predetermined constraint, which is why a measure of building land availability can stand in for supply elasticity in the empirical work that follows.

Why supply constraints should generate an asymmetric response, and not merely a stronger one, is clarified by the durable-housing framework of Glaeser and Gyourko (2005). Because housing stock is long-lived and cannot be dismantled when demand weakens, supply responds asymmetrically, expanding when demand rises but not contracting when it falls. A positive demand shock raises quantities more than prices where land is available, whereas a negative shock falls mainly on prices because the stock does not contract. The relationship between prices and population is therefore concave. The same logic implies that monetary easing and tightening don't necessarily transmit to house prices with equal force. Glaeser and Gyourko (2018) situate this argument within a broader account of housing supply, in which the gap between market prices and construction costs measures how far physical and regulatory limits push a market away from the frictionless benchmark. Together these contributions supply the theoretical basis for

expecting supply constraints to shape both the magnitude and the sign dependence of the real estate price response to monetary policy.

The clearest empirical statement of this mechanism comes from Aastveit and Anundsen (2022), whose design this thesis adapts most directly. Estimating impulse responses for 263 United States metropolitan areas by local projections, they interact narrative monetary policy shocks with the supply elasticities of Saiz (2010). Aastveit and Anundsen (2022) find that an easing surprise that lowers the policy rate by one percentage point raises real house prices by close to 7% after two years in the most supply-inelastic markets, against below 3% where supply is elastic. The asymmetry is equally central to their findings. The response to a contractionary shock is largely independent of supply elasticity, so that in inelastic markets monetary easing moves prices by roughly twice as much as tightening, while in elastic markets the ordering reverses. This pattern is what the durable-housing literature predicts, since stock that can expand but not contract capitalizes positive and negative impulses differently. Albuquerque (2024) corroborates the amplification result for the United States states within a factor-augmented vector autoregression, finding that homeownership and price-to-rent ratios fall by more after a tightening surprise where supply is inelastic. Albuquerque (2024) disagrees with Aastveit and Anundsen (2022) on the contractionary side, arguing that the response to monetary tightening is also not independent of supply constraints once financial-accelerator effects are allowed to operate. Whether the tightening response depends on supply conditions is thus an open question in the literature, and one on which district-level evidence can bear.

Evidence at the regional level within the Euro Area is more recent and rests on different moderators. Battistini et al. (2025) assemble a panel of 107 mostly NUTS2 regions across eight Euro Area countries and, using monetary policy surprises drawn from the same high-frequency database employed in this thesis, estimate a structural panel vector autoregression that separates the conventional transmission working through short-term rates from the unconventional transmission working through long-term rates. They document a pronounced within-country dimension to housing market heterogeneity and trace the differential transmission of monetary policy to regional characteristics such as homeownership rates, loan-to-value and loan-to-income ratios, and the share of fixed-rate mortgages, with the unconventional channel accounting for the bulk of the house price response over the later part of their sample. The study establishes that monetary

policy reaches European regional housing markets unevenly, but it locates the source of that unevenness in the structure of mortgage finance and tenure rather than in the elasticity of supply.

Taken together, this literature establishes that supply conditions govern how monetary policy is transmitted to house prices in the United States, and that regional heterogeneity in transmission is present in the Euro Area, yet the two strands have not been joined. The supply-elasticity mechanism has not been examined at the district level, nor through a classification based on land scarcity rather than mortgage structure, and not at all for Austria, whose pronounced geographic variation in developable land makes it a natural setting in which to do so.

3.3. Austrian Housing and Land Price Evidence

Whether the mechanism established abroad extends to Austria depends first on whether Austrian housing markets are heterogeneous enough across space for a regional analysis to be meaningful. The most direct academic evidence comes from Reiner and Musil (2023), who examine average building-land prices across 95 Austrian districts between 2000 and 2018. They document a marked widening of regional disparities, concentrated in the years of strong price growth and driven by high-priced urban and tourism-intensive districts, while many peripheral districts scarcely participated and instead converged at low price levels. The land-price boom, moreover, diffused along the urban hierarchy and to neighboring districts. Their choice of land rather than dwelling prices is instructive for the present thesis, since land is a more homogeneous good and varies far more sharply across space, with the ratio between the most and least expensive districts about ten times larger for land than for apartments. This is precisely the spatial variation in developable land that a supply-based classification seeks to exploit, and it confirms that Austrian districts differ enough in their land markets for that classification to carry information.

Whether such heterogeneity can be measured at the district level with price data has been addressed in a smaller strand of methodological literature. Mundt and Wagner (2017) construct the first hedonic price indices for second-hand apartments at the level of individual Austrian districts, though data availability confines their indices to 32 of

the 117 districts, predominantly Vienna and the larger cities.[1] They find pronounced and uneven price growth across the districts they can cover, and they frame their study explicitly as a starting point for the wider district-level analysis that richer data would permit. More recent work has continued to refine hedonic measurement for smaller Austrian markets (Spiegel, 2025). This strand demonstrates that district-level price analysis in Austria is feasible and that the underlying dynamics are heterogeneous, but it stops at the construction of price indices and does not ask how those prices respond to monetary policy.

Evidence connecting monetary policy to Austrian housing is scarcer still, and what exists operates on the demand side. Albacete and Lindner (2017) study the wealth channel using household-level survey data and find a limited but statistically significant effect of wealth on consumption in Austria, concentrated in financial rather than housing assets and concave in the level of wealth. Their analysis confirms that asset prices form part of the transmission of monetary policy in Austria, but it works through household consumption rather than through the regional formation of house prices, and it is not spatial. Taken together, the Austrian literature has documented pronounced regional disparities in land and housing prices, shown that district-level price measurement is feasible, and confirmed that the wealth channel operates domestically, yet no study has isolated the regional transmission of monetary policy to Austrian real estate prices. That is the gap this thesis addresses, and the following subsection turns the mechanism reviewed above into testable hypotheses.

3.4. Remaining Gap and Hypotheses

The literature reviewed in the preceding subsections supports a clear mechanism but leaves it untested in the present setting. Supply conditions have been shown to govern the transmission of monetary policy to real estate prices in the United States, regional heterogeneity in transmission has been documented within the Euro Area, and Austrian markets have been shown to differ sharply across space. Yet no study has estimated how monetary policy reaches Austrian real estate prices at the district level through a

[1] The figure of 117 corresponds to the count of Austrian political districts in Mundt and Wagner (2017)'s 2010-2015 sample, which treats Vienna as a single district and predates later changes to district boundaries. It is therefore not directly comparable to the 116 district panel of this thesis, which disaggregates Vienna into its 23 municipal districts.

classification based on the local scarcity of developable land. This thesis addresses that gap directly, and the mechanism it draws on yields three hypotheses that the empirical analysis can test. Each hypothesis follows from the literature, and each is revisited in light of the results when the research questions are answered.

The first hypothesis concerns the magnitude of the response. If inelastic supply causes a demand impulse to be absorbed in prices rather than in new construction, as the geography of supply and the evidence on United States metropolitan areas imply (Aastveit & Anundsen, 2022; Saiz, 2010), then a monetary easing surprise should raise prices by more where developable land is scarce. This is the direct counterpart of the primary research question, namely whether local supply constraints moderate the price response to monetary policy.

Hypothesis 1 *A monetary easing surprise raises district-level real estate prices by more in supply-inelastic districts than in supply-elastic districts.*

The second hypothesis concerns the persistence of that response over time. Because the housing stock is durable and cannot contract quickly, a price differential opened by an easing surprise should not be eroded rapidly by new supply where land is scarce, so that the gap between inelastic and elastic districts widens or holds rather than reverses over the horizons considered (Glaeser & Gyourko, 2005). This bears on the temporal sub-question, which follows the response over a three-year window.

Hypothesis 2 *The differential price response in supply-inelastic districts is more persistent over the three-year horizon than in supply-elastic districts.*

The third hypothesis concerns asymmetry between easing and tightening monetary policy surprises. The durable-housing literature implies that supply can accommodate a contraction in demand even less readily than it accommodates an expansion, so that the amplifying role of supply constraints should be concentrated in monetary easing rather than in tightening (Aastveit & Anundsen, 2022; Glaeser & Gyourko, 2005). Whether the tightening response is likewise shaped by supply conditions is contested in the literature (Albuquerque, 2024), which makes the sign of the asymmetry an empirical question worth posing directly. This corresponds to the sub-question on whether transmission is asymmetric across easing and tightening monetary policy surprises.

Hypothesis 3 *The moderating role of supply constraints is asymmetric between easing and tightening monetary policy surprises, with the amplification concentrated in easing rather than in tightening.*

These three hypotheses translate the mechanism into testable statements about magnitude, persistence, and asymmetry, and they structure the empirical analysis that follows. Whether the Austrian district-level evidence bears them out is taken up when the results are interpreted and the research questions are answered in Section 7.

4. Data and Descriptive Evidence

The empirical analysis rests on a balanced quarterly panel of Austrian districts covering the period Q1 2017 to Q4 2025. The political district is the spatial unit. The panel therefore comprises 116 districts observed over 36 quarters, which yields 4 176 district-quarter observations. Vienna is retained at the level of its individual municipal districts, so that the Viennese housing market enters the analysis at the same granularity as the remaining political districts rather than as a single aggregate. The following subsections describe the outcome variable, the monetary policy shock, the supply-constraint measure, and the control variables in turn. Further, the subsections document descriptive evidence that motivates the following empirical analysis, before the closing subsection documents how these components are combined into the estimation panel along with preliminary diagnostics of the data.

4.1. Real Estate Price Data

Residential real estate prices are provided by "DataScience Service GmbH" (2026), which compiles district-level price measures from transaction data. The data distinguish three property categories, average prices for single-family houses (HOUSE), average prices for condominium apartments (APT), and building land prices, each expressed in € per m². These data are based on land-register transaction records ("Grundbuchauszüge"). Building land is not treated as a housing outcome and is therefore excluded from the price series used in estimation. Over the full sample the price data are complete, with

an observation for every district in every quarter and no missing values in any of the three categories.

The primary outcome is a district-level composite price constructed as a fixed-weight average of the house and apartment series. For district i in quarter t, the composite price level is defined as

$$p_{i,t}^{\text{comp}} = w_i^{\text{house}} \, \text{HOUSE}_{i,t} + w_i^{\text{apt}} \, \text{APT}_{i,t}, \tag{4.1}$$

where $\text{HOUSE}_{i,t}$ and $\text{APT}_{i,t}$ are the average house and apartment prices in € per m², and the weights w_i^{house} and w_i^{apt} are held constant over the sample and are derived from the district housing stock, as described in the next paragraph. The underlying price data are in nominal terms. No district-level deflator is available at quarterly frequency, but this poses no difficulty for the analysis, since the quarter fixed effects used in the empirical strategy absorb national inflation along with every other development common to all districts in a quarter. The composite is formed at the level of prices and with fixed weights, so that cross-district property composition is held constant and only the underlying prices vary over time. This construction also motivates examining the house and apartment series separately as an alternative specification, and it provides the price series that is later transformed into the dependent variable.

The composite weights are based on the building stock recorded in the 2011 Statistik Austria building and housing census, which reports the number of dwellings by the number of dwellings within the building on the district-level (Statistik Austria, 2026d). Let D_i^1, D_i^2, $D_i^{3\text{–}5}$, $D_i^{6\text{–}10}$, $D_i^{11\text{–}20}$, and D_i^{21+} denote the 2011 dwelling counts in district i across the six building-size classes. Dwellings in single-dwelling and two-dwelling buildings are assigned to the house category, the latter to capture semi-detached and duplex dwellings, while dwellings in buildings with three or more dwellings are assigned to the apartment category. The house weight is then the house-category share of the district dwelling stock,

$$w_i^{\text{house}} = \frac{D_i^1 + D_i^2}{D_i^1 + D_i^2 + D_i^{3\text{–}5} + D_i^{6\text{–}10} + D_i^{11\text{–}20} + D_i^{21+}}, \qquad w_i^{\text{apt}} = 1 - w_i^{\text{house}}. \tag{4.2}$$

The weights are fixed at their 2011 values so that they predate the estimation window and remain exogenous to price developments during the sample, following the same logic

that governs the supply-constraint measure below.

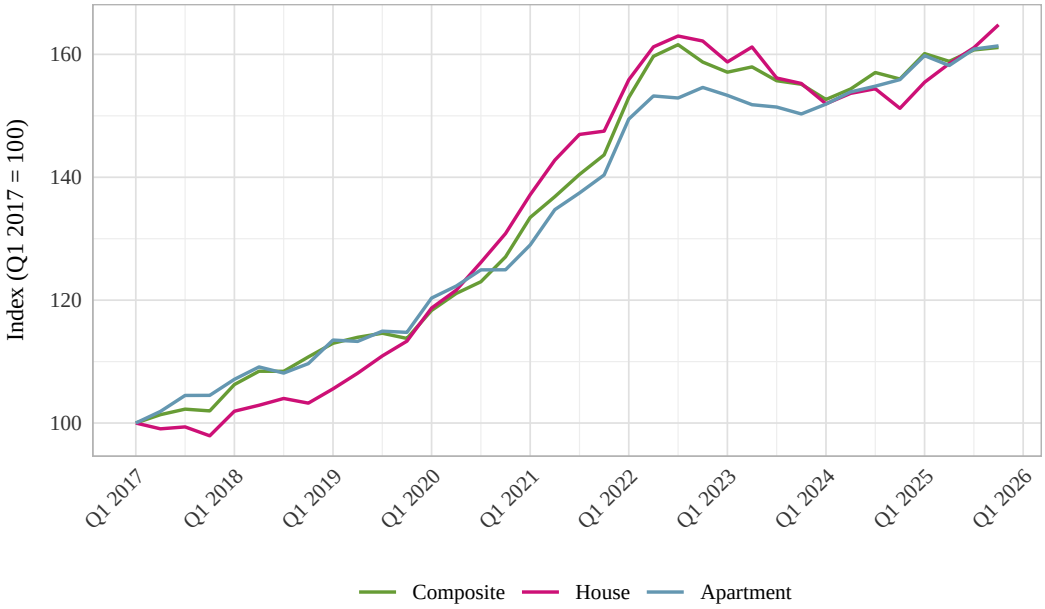


Figure 4: District price indices by property type
Unweighted district medians, Q1 2017 = 100.

Averaged over all district-quarter observations, that is, across the 116 districts and 36 quarters of the panel, the composite price is roughly € 3 260 per m², with a standard deviation across those district-quarter observations of about € 1 590 and a range that spans from under € 900 to over € 13 000 per m². This wide dispersion is the first indication of substantial regional heterogeneity in Austrian housing markets. The house and apartment series differ markedly in level, with average house prices around € 4 200 per m² exceeding average apartment prices of about € 2 870 per m². Both series are right-skewed, so that a small number of high-price districts sit well above the median. The evidence presented is descriptive and is not intended to support causal claims, since the differences reported can reflect urbanity, dwelling composition, income, and other district characteristics rather than the transmission of monetary policy. The purpose is to establish that the data contain economically meaningful regional heterogeneity in price levels, price dynamics, and supply conditions, and to surface the features that shape the specification and interpretation of the local projections analysis.

The price dispersion is closely related to supply conditions. Grouping districts by the

supply-constraint classification (see Section 4.3), the mean composite price, again pooled over all district-quarter observations, is roughly € 4 410 per m² in inelastic districts against about € 2 480 in elastic districts, so that the more supply-constrained districts operate in a distinctly higher price regime. As emphasized above, this level difference is not evidence of differential monetary transmission, since inelastic districts are also more urban and more apartment-heavy. It does, however, confirm that the supply classification separates districts that differ systematically in their housing markets, which is a precondition for the interaction analysis that follows.

More important for the empirical strategy is the time-series behavior of price growth. Quarterly composite price growth averages about 1.3% over the sample, with elastic districts growing marginally faster on average than inelastic districts. Pooling the within-district changes, the autocorrelation (ACF) of quarterly composite growth is positive and persistent, at about 0.23 at the first lag and remaining close to 0.20 up to the fourth lag. Positive autocorrelation means that a quarter of above-average price growth tends to be followed by further above-average growth, so that shocks to prices are not reversed immediately but propagate over several quarters. Price momentum is a well-documented feature of housing markets (Case & Shiller, 1988; Guren, 2018), and reflects the slow diffusion of information, search frictions, and the staggered nature of transactions in illiquid property markets.

The presence of price momentum has a direct methodological implication. If lagged price changes predict current growth and are also correlated with the timing of monetary policy surprises, omitting them would confound the estimated response with the ongoing momentum of the local market. Following Aastveit and Anundsen (2022), who include four lags of house-price changes in their panel local projections precisely to absorb this momentum, the control vector therefore includes four lagged quarterly changes of the composite price. The lag profile in Figure 5 supports this choice. The partial autocorrelation (pACF), which measures the additional predictive content of each further lag once the earlier lags are accounted for, is positive and significant up to the fourth lag and then sharply falls at the fifth, so four lags capture the independent momentum content without adding redundant terms. The negative correlations at longer lags are consistent with a differenced series and do not reflect the positive momentum the controls are meant to absorb. The same persistence, combined with the overlapping cumulative outcomes of the local projections, is also a source of serial correlation in the residuals,

which is why the treatment of standard errors requires particular care in the empirical strategy.

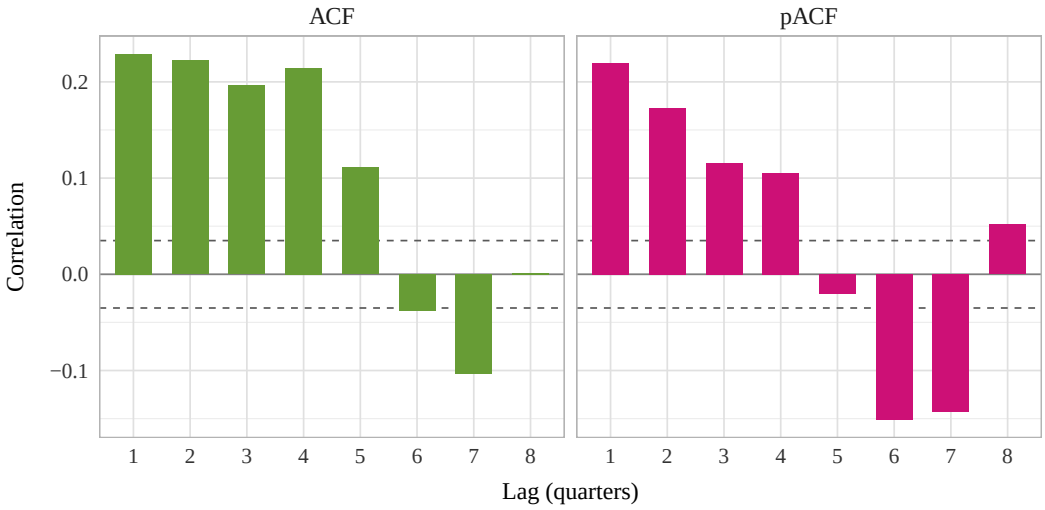


Figure 5: Autocorrelation and partial autocorrelation of quarterly composite price growth
Pooled within-district estimates by lag. Dashed lines mark the approximate white-noise significance band, $\pm 1.96/\sqrt{n}$.

4.2. Monetary Policy Shocks

The monetary policy shock is constructed from the Euro Area Monetary Policy Event-Study Database of Altavilla et al. (2019), which records high-frequency changes in a range of asset prices within tight windows around ECB policy announcements. The chosen instrument is the surprise in the twenty-year overnight index swap rate (OIS 20Y). This maturity is selected because residential real estate prices depend on expected long-term financing conditions rather than on the current policy rate. Housing is a long-lived asset, and its value can be approximated by the discounted stream of expected future service flows (rents or imputed rent), so a change in the long-term discount rate has a larger valuation effect than a change in short rates (He & La Cava, 2020), a channel that operates through housing wealth in the euro area (Di Casola & Grothe, 2026). Consistent with this, the transmission of ECB policy, and of its asset purchase programmes in particular, works to a large extent through the long end of the yield curve (Eser et al., 2019), so that surprises at longer maturities are the component of

monetary policy most relevant for housing valuations. The twenty-year and thirty-year German government bond yield surprises are retained only as alternative instruments for robustness.

The event-level surprises are aggregated to the quarterly frequency of the panel by summing all surprises within a quarter into a net quarterly shock. Alongside the net measure, the sum of positive surprises, the sum of negative surprises, and the sum of absolute surprises are recorded for each quarter, which supports the signed decomposition used to examine asymmetric responses. The sign convention follows the interpretation of the underlying instrument, a negative OIS 20Y surprise denotes a downward revision of long-term rate expectations and therefore a monetary easing surprise. This convention matters for the interpretation of the estimated coefficients and is carried through consistently in the empirical analysis. Over the sample, the mean net quarterly surprise is negative, at roughly -0.59, consistent with the prevailing monetary easing stance during much of the period, and the largest absolute net surprises occur in Q3 2019 and around the onset of the tightening cycle in 2022 and 2023.

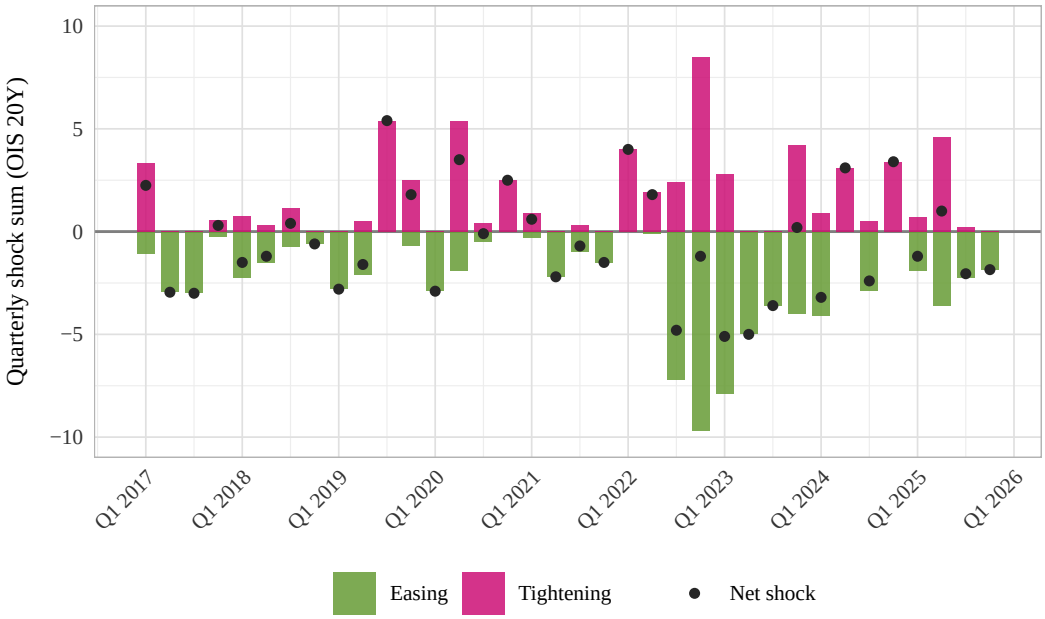


Figure 6: Quarterly monetary policy shock components
Easing surprises denoted as negative, tightening surprises denoted as positive; points = net quarterly sum

A preliminary diagnostic examines how far the quarterly net sum conceals offsetting surprises within a quarter. The cancellation ratio, defined as the net shock (net sum of shocks in a quarter) divided by the absolute sum of surprises in a quarter, has a mean of about 0.69, which indicates that easing and tightening surprises frequently occur within the same quarter and partly offset in the net measure. The ratio is a diagnostic rather than an additional regressor, and the extent of within-quarter cancellation motivates an asymmetric specification that separates the easing and tightening components of the shock, which the empirical strategy adopts as an alternative specification.

Both easing and tightening quarters are well represented, with an easing surprise component present in 31 of the 36 quarters and a tightening surprise component in 26, and both signs occurring within the same quarter in 21 quarters. This overlap is the source of the within-quarter cancellation documented above, and the presence of both directions of surprise is what makes the sample suitable for examining whether price responses differ between easing and tightening surprises. Because the shock is common to all districts within a quarter, its aggregate effect is absorbed by the time fixed effects, and the descriptive variation reported here bears on the identifying interaction only through its differential incidence across the supply groups.

4.3. Supply-Constraint Measure

Regional differences in housing supply are captured through the district building land reserve recorded in the ÖROK monitoring of building land reserves (ÖROK Monitoring of Building Land Reserves, 2025a), which measures the share of vacant developable land in total designated building land. A lower reserve indicates less room for additional construction and therefore a more supply-inelastic district. To predate the estimation window, the 2014 level of the reserve is used throughout, so that the classification cannot respond to price developments during the sample.

Districts are classified as supply-inelastic using the twenty-fifth percentile of the reserve distribution outside Vienna, a threshold of around 22%, which is then applied to all districts. This procedure classifies 47 districts as inelastic and 69 as elastic. Of the inelastic districts, 24 lie outside Vienna and 23 are Viennese municipal districts (see Appendix Table A.3). The measure is a proxy for supply conditions rather than a directly estimated supply elasticity, and it is strongly structured along geographic and compositional

lines. In particular, the reserve measure correlates at about 0.91 with the fixed house weight, so that inelastic districts tend also to be apartment-heavy. The interpretation of this entanglement is developed below, alongside the correlation evidence. District fixed effects absorb time-invariant level differences of this kind, but the entanglement of supply constraints with geography and property composition remains a concern for interpretation. For this reason the analysis later reports property-specific outcomes and a continuous reserve measure as alternative specifications, and re-estimates the model on the sample excluding Vienna as a robustness check.

The building land reserve varies considerably across districts, with a median of about 24% and values ranging from close to zero to above 45%. The supply classification is strongly clustered by federal state, as Figure 7 illustrates. The map displays the underlying continuous reserve rather than the binary split, so that variation remains visible even within districts that are uniformly classified, as among the Viennese municipal districts shown in the lower panel. All Viennese districts and all Salzburg districts fall into the inelastic group, while Burgenland contains no inelastic districts, and the median reserve in Vienna, at under 5%, is far below that of the predominantly rural states. This geographic concentration is economically intuitive, since the most supply-constrained districts are the dense urban and Alpine areas where developable land is genuinely scarce, but it also implies that the supply measure is entangled with region and with property composition.

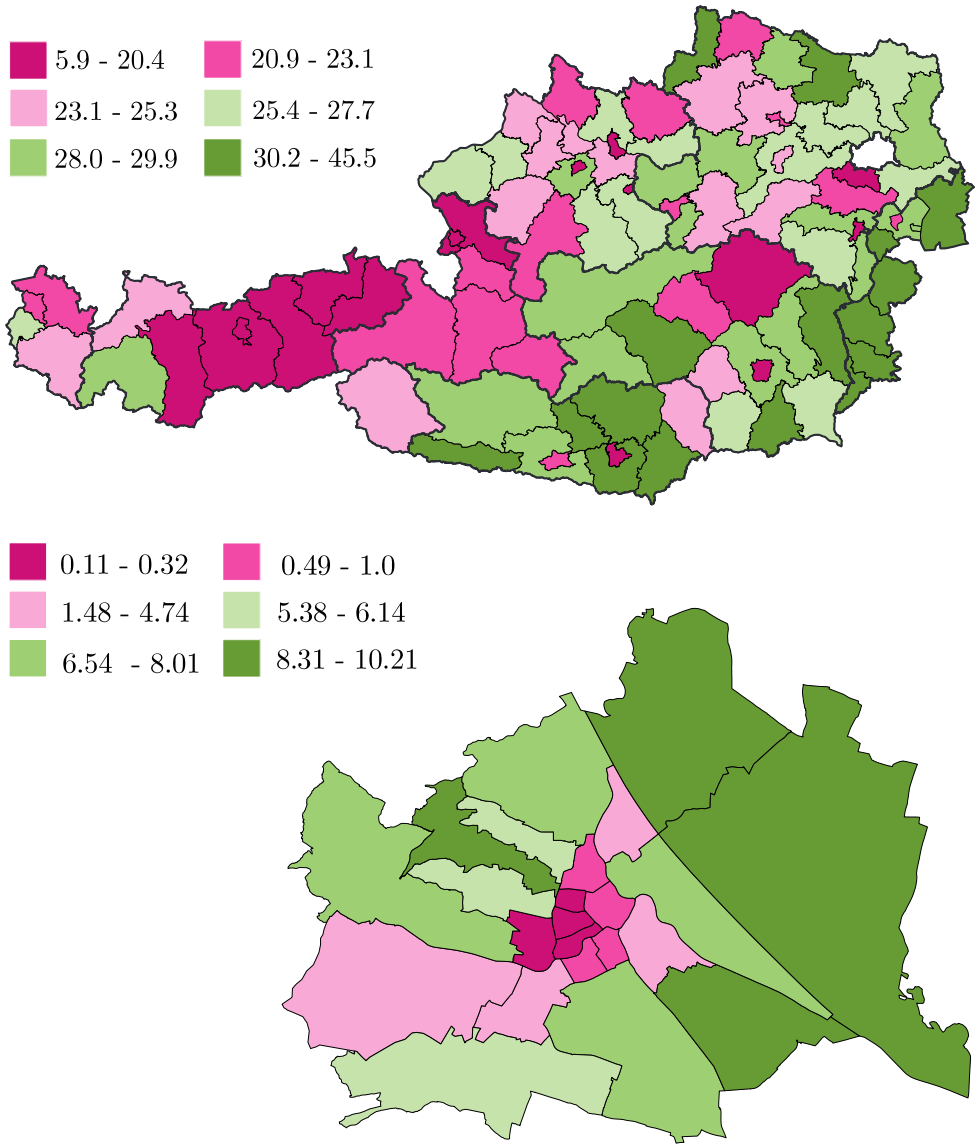


Figure 7: Building land reserve across Austrian districts
Share of vacant developable land in total designated building land, 2014, by district. Top: Austrian districts excl. Vienna. Bottom: 23 Viennese municipal districts. Six quantile classes of the district reserve distribution. Source: ÖROK Monitoring of Building Land Reserves (2025a).

This entanglement carries two implications that are taken up in the empirical analysis. First, district fixed effects remove time-invariant differences in price levels and composition, but they do not by themselves rule out that districts differing in these

correlated characteristics also respond differently to a common shock for reasons other than supply elasticity. Second, because the interaction with the shock is by construction non-zero only for inelastic districts, and because all Viennese districts are inelastic, the identifying variation is concentrated in a structurally distinctive set of markets. These considerations motivate the alternative specifications reported alongside the baseline, the continuous reserve measure and the property-specific outcomes, as well as the Vienna-excluded robustness check, and they caution against reading the baseline interaction as a clean measure of supply elasticity alone.

4.4. Control Variables

The control set comprises district-level population, the unemployment rate, and net income per capita, each aligned to the quarterly frequency of the panel. Population is available quarterly from the central residence register and enters directly (Statistik Austria, 2026b). Unemployment is available annually at the district level and is carried across the four quarters of each year (Statistik Austria, 2026a). Net income per capita is constructed by dividing annual district net income totals (Statistik Austria, 2026e) by the corresponding population, so that within-year variation in income per capita partly reflects population movements. This construction creates a mechanical correlation between income growth and population growth. Since these series are annual in origin, the quarterly panel repeats the annual figures within each year, and this is reflected in the way the control lags behave.

Several series require construction at the tail of the sample, where source data are not yet available. Annual net income is observed through 2022 and is extrapolated for 2023 to 2025 using the nominal Tariflohnindex (OeNB - Österreichische Nationalbank, 2026a), so that all districts share a common wage-index growth path over the extrapolated years. District unemployment is observed through 2024 and carried forward to 2025, and population is carried forward from the first quarter of 2025 to the remaining quarters of that year. These constructed values are complete observations, but they do not represent newly observed district information. Their share is largest at the end of the sample and declines at longer horizons as later quarters drop out of the estimation window. To ensure that these choices do not drive the findings, the analysis reports a sensitivity sample that excludes the constructed tail.

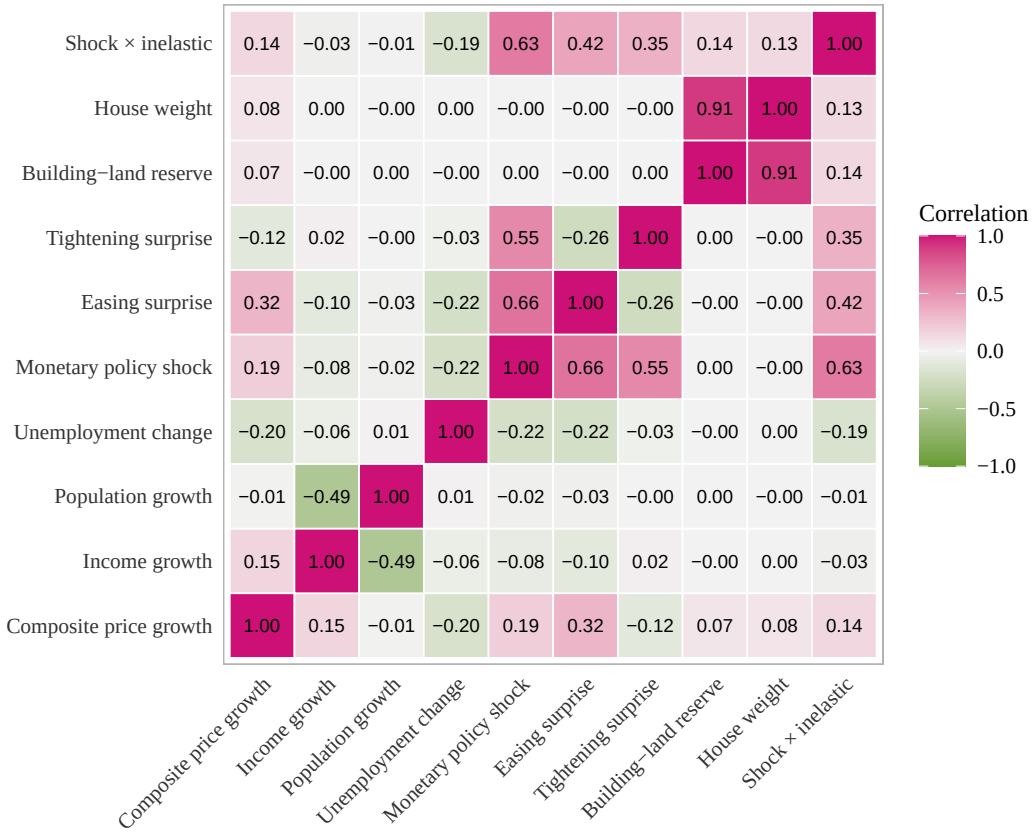


Figure 8: Pairwise correlations of key variables
Pooled Pearson correlations over all district-quarter observations, computed on pairwise-complete cases.

Figure 8 reports the pairwise correlations among the outcome, the controls, the shock and its signed components, the supply measures, and the shock-by-inelastic interaction. The matrix serves two purposes, it documents that the shock behaves as an external regressor with respect to district characteristics, and it surfaces one strong association that shapes the interpretation of the results.

The most reassuring result for identification is the relation of the shock to the district-level variables. The shock is essentially uncorrelated with the two time-invariant supply measures, with a coefficient at 0.00 with both the building land reserve and the fixed house weight. Further, it correlates only weakly with the district controls, at −0.08 with

income growth, −0.02 with population growth, and −0.22 with the change in unemployment. The near-zero correlation with the time-invariant measures is mechanical rather than coincidental, since a common national surprise carries no cross-sectional variation that could line up with fixed district traits, but it nonetheless confirms that the identifying variation in the shock does not proxy for the supply classification. The modest negative correlation with the unemployment change is consistent with monetary easing coinciding with weaker labor market conditions, and it motivates the inclusion of the controls rather than raising a collinearity concern.

The shock also relates to the outcome in the expected direction. The net shock correlates at 0.19 with quarterly composite price growth, where the signed decomposition is more informative, with the easing component correlating at 0.32 and the tightening component at −0.12. Under the convention that easing surprises enter negatively, these signs indicate that price growth is higher in quarters with larger easing surprises. Within the shock block, the net measure correlates at 0.66 with the easing component and at 0.55 with the tightening component, while the two signed components correlate at −0.26 with each other, reflecting the within-quarter cancellation documented in Section 4.2. The interaction term correlates at 0.63 with the net shock, as expected since it is the shock scaled by the relative share of districts classified as inelastic, and only weakly, at around 0.13 to 0.14, with the two supply measures.

Among the controls, the strongest association is the −0.49 correlation between income growth and population growth. This is largely mechanical, as income per capita is constructed by dividing an annual district income total by quarterly population, so that movements in the denominator enter both series with opposite sign, as noted in Section 4.4. The remaining control correlations are small, with composite price growth correlating at −0.20 with the change in unemployment and at 0.15 with income growth, which is consistent with local demand conditions without indicating redundancy among the regressors.

The one association that requires closer attention is the 0.91 correlation between the building land reserve and the fixed house weight. Because inelastic districts are predominantly urban and apartment-heavy, the supply classification and the composite property mix carry closely related cross-sectional information, so that the inelastic indicator partly captures the difference between apartment markets and house markets rather than land scarcity alone. This entanglement is the central measurement concern

of the analysis.

By construction, apartments carry more weight in the housing stock of urban and therefore inelastic districts. Simultaneously, apartment-heavy markets are more strongly shaped by investor demand than owner-occupied house markets. This matters because the two segments do not respond to monetary policy in the same way. Biljanovska et al. (2025) document that investor demand, measured through non-owner-occupied purchases, contracts more sharply after monetary tightening, a pattern they attribute to investors extending recent price trends into their expectations of future returns, which makes their demand particularly sensitive to financing conditions. Investors evaluate housing as one asset among others and discount expected future returns at market interest rates, so that a shift in the policy stance revalues investor-held property more forcefully than owner-occupied housing, where the decision to buy or sell is tied to housing needs rather than to the rate of return (He & La Cava, 2020). The behavioral evidence points in the same direction, as Genesove and Mayer (2001) find that owner-occupants adjust their asking prices far more reluctantly than investors when facing nominal losses, so that owner-occupied house markets are the stickier of the two segments. The Austrian tenure structure is consistent with this reasoning. Using the 2024 building and housing census and the same building-size classification that defines the composite weights, the stock-weighted owner-occupancy rate is only about 19% in Vienna, whose districts are all classified as inelastic, against about 61% in Austria excluding Vienna (Statistik Austria, 2026c). The supply-inelastic set is therefore also the part of the country where rental and investor-held dwellings dominate, precisely the segment the literature identifies as most sensitive to monetary policy.

This literature therefore indicates that the apartment-heavy composition of inelastic districts is not merely a statistical nuisance but a channel that plausibly reinforces the supply mechanism, since the districts classified as inelastic are also those in which the more monetary-sensitive investor segment is most prominent. The two channels nonetheless cannot be fully separated within the current design, as the inelastic indicator jointly reflects land scarcity and property composition. The analysis therefore does not claim that the interaction isolates a pure supply-elasticity effect, and it addresses the concern directly through the property-specific outcomes and the continuous reserve measure reported as alternative specifications, together with the Vienna-excluded robustness check, which the empirical strategy addresses in detail.

4.5. Panel Construction and Preliminary Diagnostics

The estimation panel is assembled by merging the price series, the composite weights, the supply-constraint classification, the quarterly shock, and the three control variables on the district and quarter keys. The price series and controls vary by district and quarter, the shock is common across districts within a quarter, and the supply classification and composite weights are time-invariant district characteristics. Districts are identified by a consistent numeric code across all sources, and the Viennese municipal districts are aligned to the three-digit district scheme used throughout the panel.

A set of preliminary diagnostics confirms that the merge preserves the intended structure of the data. All component inputs join without duplicate or unmatched keys, every district appears in every quarter, and the price series contain no non-positive or non-finite values, so the merged panel is balanced and complete at 4 176 district-quarter observations (covering 116 districts over 36 quarters). Summary statistics for the outcome, the shock, the supply measure, and the controls, together with the integrity checks underlying these statements, are reported in Appendix A.1. The descriptive evidence discussed above draws on this panel, and the diagnostics reported here establish that the regularities documented in the preceding subsections reflect the data.

The dependent variable and the lagged controls introduce structural missing values by construction rather than through gaps in the source data. The cumulative outcome at horizon h, the change in the log composite price measured relative to the quarter preceding the shock, together with the four lagged quarterly changes that enter as controls, reduces the usable sample from 3 596 observations at the shortest horizon to 2 204 at the longest. All 116 districts remain represented at every horizon, but each additional horizon removes the most recent quarter, so that comparisons of coefficients across horizons also compare progressively earlier samples. This feature is inherent to the local projection design and is disclosed alongside the estimates.

5. Empirical Strategy

The following chapter describes how the district-quarter panel is used to estimate how the dynamic response of real estate prices to ECB monetary policy shocks differs between supply-elastic and supply-inelastic districts. The approach is a panel local projections

analysis, which traces the price-response over a three-year horizon and identifies the differential effect through the interaction of the shock with the supply-constraint classification. The following subsections introduce the local projection method, specify the baseline model and its identifying assumptions, explain the interpretation of the coefficient of interest, describe the outcome transformation and the fixed-effects structure, and discuss the treatment of inference. Further, the concluding subsection in this chapter discusses alternative model specifications and robustness checks.

5.1. Panel Local Projections

The question motivating this thesis is inherently dynamic, since the interest lies not only in whether prices react to a monetary policy shock but in how that reaction unfolds over the quarters that follow. A common way to trace such a reaction is vector autoregression, which summarizes the joint dynamics of a set of variables in a single system and then projects that system forward to obtain the response at each horizon. The drawback is that the response at a distant horizon is built from the same estimated system used at the nearest one, so that any error in how the system is specified accumulates as the horizon grows (Jordà, 2005). For a study concerned with responses up to three years ahead, this accumulation is a concern.

Local projections offer a more direct route and are the method adopted here. Rather than relying on a single system, a separate regression is run for each horizon, relating the price outcome several quarters ahead to the shock and to controls measured at the time of the shock, and the response is obtained from the coefficients on the shock across this sequence of regressions (Jordà, 2005). The appeal of this method for the setting of this thesis is threefold. It is estimated by ordinary least squares (OLS) and thus extends without difficulty to a panel with district and time fixed effects. Because each horizon is estimated separately, a misspecification of the dynamics at one horizon does not contaminate the others. And it accommodates the interaction between the shock and a district characteristic that lies at the center of this analysis, which would be far less straightforward to impose within a full multivariate system. One drawback is that the outcomes used across horizons overlap in time, which leaves the residuals serially correlated and requires care in the treatment of standard errors, a concern discussed in detail below.

These properties carry over naturally to a panel, for which Jordà (2023) describes local projections as a way of connecting the impulse-response tradition of macroeconomics with the treatment-effect reasoning of applied microeconomics, with the shock playing the role of an intervention whose effect is followed through time. In this thesis the panel does more than accommodate the method. Since the shock is the same for every district in a given quarter, its overall effect on Austrian real estate prices cannot be separated from anything else happening nationally in that quarter, and it is not the object of interest. What can be identified is how districts differ in their reaction according to their supply conditions, which follows from interacting the common shock with the district-level classification. The construction of that interaction, and the fixed-effects structure that isolates the differential it captures, are developed in the following subsections.

5.2. Baseline Model and Identification

The baseline specification follows the panel local projection design of Aastveit and Anundsen (2022), adapted to the Austrian district-level setting. For each horizon $h = 0, 1, \ldots, 12$, a separate regression is estimated of the form:

$$y_{i,t+h} - y_{i,t-1} = \alpha_{i,h} + \tau_{t,h} + \beta_h \left(\text{Shock}_t \times \text{Inelastic}_i\right) + \theta_h' X_{i,t} + \varepsilon_{i,t+h}, \tag{5.1}$$

where i indexes districts and t quarters. The dependent variable $y_{i,t+h} - y_{i,t-1}$ is the cumulative change in the log composite price between the quarter preceding the shock and horizon h, so that the sequence of coefficients traces the response of prices over a maximum period of three years. The outcome construction is described in detail below. The horizon runs from the quarter of the shock, $h = 0$, to twelve quarters ahead, which spans the three-year window over which the price response is of interest.

The regressor of interest is the interaction $\text{Shock}_t \times \text{Inelastic}_i$, formed from the quarterly net OIS 20Y surprise and the time-invariant supply classification. Here $\text{Inelastic}_i \in \{0, 1\}$ is an indicator equal to one for districts classified as supply-inelastic and zero otherwise, constructed as described in Section 4.3. Its coefficient β_h is the object the analysis seeks to estimate, and it measures how the price response at horizon h differs between inelastic and elastic districts. The binary indicator is used as the baseline because it yields a directly interpretable differential between elasticity-groups. The same supply

constraint is also measured continuously, through the underlying building land reserve, and the analysis reports that specification alongside the binary one as a complementary and more efficient use of the supply information; the two are developed together in the concluding subsection. The term $\alpha_{i,h}$ denotes district fixed effects and $\tau_{t,h}$ quarter fixed effects, both estimated separately at each horizon; their role in isolating the differential response is discussed below. The vector $X_{i,t}$ collects the control variables, entered as four quarterly lags each of the change in the log composite price, the change in log income per capita, population growth, and the change in the unemployment rate, following the lag structure motivated in Section 4.1.

Two features of this specification deserve emphasis. First, the shock enters only through its interaction with the supply classification, not on its own. Because the surprise is common to all districts within a quarter, its level is perfectly collinear with the quarter fixed effects and cannot be separately estimated, so the specification is designed to recover the differential response rather than the aggregate one. Second, the coefficient of interest is allowed to vary freely across horizons, since each β_h is estimated in its own regression, which is what permits the response to build, peak, and fade over the three-year window without imposing a particular dynamic shape. The interpretation of β_h, including the role of the sign convention on the shock, is developed below, as are the assumptions required for it to carry a causal reading.

5.3. Outcome Transformation

The dependent variable is a cumulative log-price change, which is the standard outcome in the local projection literature (Jordà, 2005, 2023) and the one used by Aastveit and Anundsen (2022). Let $p_{i,t}^{\text{comp}}$ denote the composite price of district i in quarter t, constructed as described in Section 4.1, and let $y_{i,t} = \ln p_{i,t}^{\text{comp}}$ be its natural logarithm. The outcome at horizon h is the change in this log price between the quarter preceding the shock and h quarters after it,

$$y_{i,t+h} - y_{i,t-1} = \ln p_{i,t+h}^{\text{comp}} - \ln p_{i,t-1}^{\text{comp}}, \tag{5.2}$$

so that a separate outcome is formed for each horizon $h = 0, 1, \ldots, 12$. Because it is a difference in logarithms, the outcome measures the cumulative growth of the composite

price from the pre-shock quarter to horizon h, and for the moderate changes observed over the sample it is closely approximated by the corresponding percentage change. Expressing the response as a proportional change also places every district on a common percentage scale, so that a euro movement counts relative to the local price level rather than in absolute terms. This matters in a panel where the composite price ranges from under € 900 to over € 13 000 per m^2, since it prevents the response from being mechanically larger in the most expensive districts. The district fixed effects remove differences in the price *level*, whereas the log transformation governs the scale on which the change itself is measured.

Two aspects of this construction shape the interpretation of the estimates. First, the outcome is measured relative to quarter $t-1$ rather than quarter t. Anchoring the base in the quarter before the shock ensures that the horizon-zero outcome, $y_{i,t} - y_{i,t-1}$, already captures the immediate within-quarter movement in prices, so that the response is measured from a point that is not itself contaminated by the shock. Second, the outcome is cumulative rather than a period-by-period change. Each β_h therefore describes the differential response of the price *level* by horizon h, measured from its pre-shock value, rather than the differential growth in that single quarter. The sequence $\{\beta_h\}_{h=0}^{12}$ consequently traces the full path of the accumulated price response over the three-year window, which is the object of the temporal sub-question introduced in Section 1.

Forming the outcome from leads of the log price mechanically removes the final quarters of each district from the longer-horizon regressions, since the price twelve quarters ahead is not observed for the most recent quarters of the sample. The resulting decline in the estimation sample with the horizon, and its implication that longer-horizon coefficients rest on progressively earlier quarters, is documented in Section 4.5 and is revisited when the results are interpreted.

5.4. Interpretation of the Coefficient

The coefficient β_h is the central estimate of the analysis, and its interpretation follows directly from the structure of the model. Since the shock enters only through its interaction with the inelastic indicator, β_h measures the difference in the cumulative price response at horizon h between a supply-inelastic and a supply-elastic district exposed to the same monetary policy surprise. In the language of dynamic treatment effects, to

which Jordà (2023) connects the local projection, β_h is the additional effect of the shock on inelastic districts relative to the elastic benchmark, traced out over the three-year window. It is not the response of any district in isolation, and it is not the average response across all districts, both of which are bound up with the common time effect and cannot be recovered from this specification.

The sign of β_h must be read together with the sign convention on the shock, and the two combine in a way that is easily misread. A negative OIS 20Y surprise denotes monetary easing (see Section 4.2), so the shock variable takes negative values in easing quarters. The differential effect on the cumulative price response of an inelastic district is the product $\beta_h \times \text{Shock}_t$. If, as the mechanism in this thesis suggests, easing raises prices more strongly where supply is constrained, then this product must be positive in an easing quarter, which requires β_h to be negative. A negative estimate of β_h therefore supports the hypothesis of a stronger response in inelastic districts. To avoid this ambiguity, the results are reported and discussed in terms of the implied response to a monetary easing surprise of a given size, rather than in terms of the raw coefficient alone.

This differential reading is the direct empirical counterpart of the research question, and it mirrors the approach of Aastveit and Anundsen (2022), who interpret the interaction between a monetary policy shock and a measure of supply elasticity as the extent to which tighter supply amplifies the price response. The magnitude of β_h is expressed in the units of the outcome, so that it represents the differential cumulative change in the log composite price, in log points, by horizon h, in response to a one-unit surprise. The full sequence $\{\beta_h\}$ describes how this differential builds and evolves over the twelve quarters, which speaks to the temporal sub-question, while its sign and persistence speak to whether supply constraints amplify or merely delay the transmission of monetary policy to regional prices. Whether β_h can be given a causal rather than a purely associational reading depends on the identifying assumptions discussed below.

5.5. Fixed Effects

The specification includes both district and quarter fixed effects, estimated separately at each horizon, and each serves a distinct purpose. District fixed effects $\alpha_{i,h}$ absorb all time-invariant characteristics of a district, including its average price level, its position

in the supply-constraint classification, and its fixed property composition. This matters given the concern raised in Section 4.4 that the inelastic indicator is closely tied to an apartment-heavy housing stock. By removing the cross-sectional level differences between districts, the district effects ensure that β_h is not driven by the fact that inelastic districts are more expensive or more urban on average, but by how their prices move differently over time.

Quarter fixed effects $\tau_{t,h}$ are what allow the model to be read as a differential response. They absorb everything common to all districts within a given quarter, including the level of the monetary policy shock itself, the national housing cycle, euro-area financial conditions, and any other aggregate development. Because the shock does not vary across districts within a quarter, its level is perfectly collinear with the quarter fixed effects and drops out of the regression, as noted in Section 5.2. The only variation left to identify β_h is therefore cross-sectional and within-quarter, namely the difference in how inelastic and elastic districts respond to the same aggregate surprise. This is a deliberate feature rather than a limitation, since it removes at a stroke the large class of confounders that operate at the national level and would otherwise contaminate an estimate of the aggregate response.

This two-way structure follows Aastveit and Anundsen (2022), who combine regional fixed effects with the interaction between the shock and supply elasticity, and whose extended specification adds region-by-time effects to absorb common regional developments. In the present setting the quarter fixed effects already absorb all national variation, and the panel is not large enough along the cross-sectional dimension to add Bundesland-by-quarter fixed effects, the Austrian analogue of these region-by-time effects, without exhausting the identifying variation. The fixed effects carry the horizon subscript h because a separate regression is estimated at each horizon, so that the absorbed level differences and common shocks are allowed to matter differently at different points of the response path. In practice each horizon regression is estimated by ordinary least squares (OLS) with the two sets of fixed effects absorbed through the within transformation, which removes the district and quarter means without estimating a separate coefficient for each unit. What this structure cannot absorb are district-specific developments that are correlated with the supply classification and that happen to coincide with the timing of the shocks, and the plausibility of ruling can be found below.

5.6. Inference and Identification Assumptions

Valid inference is the most delicate part of the design, because the residuals of a panel local projection are dependent along two dimensions at once. The first dimension is temporal. Because the outcome at each horizon accumulates the price change from the same base quarter, the regressions at adjacent horizons are built from overlapping windows of data, so their residuals are expected to be serially correlated within districts. Subsequently, residuals are expected to display stronger serial correlation at longer lags, where the accumulation windows overlap for more quarters. The price momentum documented in Section 4.1 reinforces this concern, since persistent local growth is itself a source of within-district serial correlation. The second dimension is cross-sectional. Districts are exposed to the same national shock and the same aggregate housing cycle, and neighboring markets are linked through common regional developments, so the residuals are expected to be correlated across districts within a given quarter. Ordinary standard errors, which assume independence, would understate the true sampling uncertainty on both counts and cannot be used.

The inference reported throughout rests on the standard errors of Driscoll and Kraay (1998), which extend the nonparametric time-series correction of Newey and West (1987) to a panel and remain valid under broad patterns of dependence both across districts and over time. This estimator is the natural choice in the present setting for two reasons. It addresses the serial and the cross-sectional dependence together, matching the two-dimensional structure of the residuals, and it is the correction used in the regional local projection literature on which this thesis draws, most directly Aastveit and Anundsen (2022). An alternative would be two-way clustering by district and quarter in the manner of Cameron et al. (2011), but its asymptotics require many clusters in both dimensions, and with only 36 quarterly clusters the time dimension would be the binding constraint, so the clustered errors would tend to be understated. The Driscoll-Kraay standard errors are therefore preferred.

The Driscoll and Kraay (1998) asymptotic justification nonetheless relies on a growing time dimension, which is a genuine limitation at 36 quarters, and this is the point at which the overlapping-horizon serial correlation is most likely to distort inference. To confront this directly, the analysis reports the lag-augmentation approach of Montiel Olea and Plagborg-Møller (2021) as a robustness check on inference. Adding lags of

the dependent variable to each horizon regression absorbs the serial correlation that the projection structure induces, so that heteroskedasticity-robust standard errors become valid without relying on a large time dimension, which is precisely the assumption under strain here. Treating this more recent, projection-specific method as a check on the Driscoll-Kraay results guards against the small-sample weakness of the primary estimator without making statistical significance conditional on the agreement of several corrections, which would raise the risk of discarding genuine effects.

The corrections just discussed concern the precision of the estimates, that is, whether the standard errors around β_h are trustworthy. Reading β_h as a causal differential rather than a mere correlation is a separate matter, and it rests on three identifying assumptions that the fixed effects and the standard errors cannot by themselves secure.

(A1) Shock exogeneity. The monetary policy surprise must be exogenous with respect to Austrian district housing conditions. This is the rationale for the high-frequency identification of Altavilla et al. (2019), which isolates the component of policy that is unanticipated by measuring asset-price movements in a tight window around ECB announcements, so that the surprise is plausibly uncorrelated with developments already underway in regional housing markets. The main threat to this assumption is the central-bank information effect, whereby announcements also convey the central bank's assessment of the economic outlook (Jarociński & Karadi, 2020). Since the shock enters only in interaction with a district characteristic, however, any such aggregate information content is absorbed by the quarter fixed effects and does not by itself bias the differential.

(A2) No confounding district characteristic. No omitted district characteristic may be both correlated with the supply classification and differentially responsive to the common shock. This is precisely the class of confounder that the fixed effects cannot absorb, as noted in Section 5.5, and it is the reason the entanglement between supply inelasticity and property composition documented in Section 4.4 matters for interpretation rather than only for description. The analysis does not claim to rule this out by assumption, but confronts it through the alternative specifications and robustness checks described in Section 5.7, which measure the supply constraint continuously as well as through the binary split, isolate the house and apartment segments where each is economically material, and re-estimate the model on the sample excluding Vienna.

(A3) Validity of the supply proxy. The building land reserve must be a valid proxy for the elasticity of local housing supply. As discussed in Section 4.3, the reserve is a predetermined measure of the scope for additional construction rather than a directly estimated elasticity. Taken together, assumptions (A1) to (A3) define the conditions under which β_h can be read as the causal differential response of supply-inelastic districts, and the discussion of results returns to their plausibility where relevant.

5.7. Alternative Specifications and Robustness

The analysis reports a set of departures from the baseline specification that fall into two groups, distinguished by their purpose. Alternative specifications change the model of the effect itself and are reported alongside the baseline, because they characterize the response rather than merely testing its durability. Robustness checks instead vary an estimation or sample choice while leaving the effect of interest unchanged, in order to show that the baseline finding is not an artifact of a particular decision. The distinction follows the practice of Aastveit and Anundsen (2022), and each of these departures is motivated by a specific feature of the data documented in Section 4.

Four alternative specifications are considered. **(AS1) Property-specific outcomes.** The model is re-estimated with the house and apartment series as separate outcomes in place of the composite, which tests whether the composite result is an artifact of the fixed property-mix weighting and speaks to the entanglement between supply inelasticity and property composition discussed in Section 4.4. In its unweighted form this split treats every district equally, regardless of whether a given segment is economically material there, so the apartment response is estimated in part on districts whose stock is overwhelmingly houses, and conversely. **(AS1b) Stock-weighted property-specific outcomes.** To address this, the property-specific regressions are re-estimated by weighted least squares, weighting each district-quarter by the fixed stock share of the segment being modeled, the house share (w_i^{house}) for the house outcome and the apartment share (w_i^{apt}) for the apartment outcome. A district then contributes to a segment in proportion to how relevant that segment is to its local market, so thinly represented segments add little noise, which is the economically appropriate way to isolate a property-type response given the heterogeneous composition documented in Section 4.1. Because weighting toward apartment-heavy districts would compress the

variation of the binary indicator, the weighted specification uses the continuous reserve interaction introduced below. **(AS2) Asymmetric shock decomposition.** The net shock is decomposed into its easing and tightening components, which is required to address the sub-question on whether the transmission of monetary policy is asymmetric between easing and tightening surprises. The decomposition is estimated on both the binary and the continuous supply measure, so that the asymmetry can be read through the same two lenses as the level response. For each horizon h, this specification replaces the single interaction in Equation 5.1 with two,

$$\begin{aligned} y_{i,t+h} - y_{i,t-1} = \alpha_{i,h} + \tau_{t,h} + \beta_h^{\text{ease}} \left(\text{Shock}_t^{\text{ease}} \times \text{Inelastic}_i\right) \\ + \beta_h^{\text{tight}} \left(\text{Shock}_t^{\text{tight}} \times \text{Inelastic}_i\right) + \theta_h' X_{i,t} + \varepsilon_{i,t+h}, \end{aligned} \tag{5.3}$$

where $\text{Shock}_t^{\text{ease}}$ and $\text{Shock}_t^{\text{tight}}$ are the within-quarter sums of the negative and positive OIS 20Y surprises respectively, so that β_h^{ease} and β_h^{tight} measure the differential response of inelastic districts to easing and tightening surprises separately. **(AS3) Continuous supply measure.** The binary inelastic indicator is replaced with the building land reserve entered continuously, standardized so that a higher value denotes a more supply-constrained district and its coefficient is comparable in direction to the binary interaction. Although listed here among the alternative specifications, this measure is reported alongside the baseline rather than as a mere durability check, for an econometric reason. Dichotomizing a continuous characteristic into two groups discards the gradient of supply conditions and identifies the differential only from the between-group contrast, which is a known source of lost information and reduces statistical power relative to using the variable in its continuous form. The continuous measure retains the full cross-sectional variation in the reserve, so that, under the maintained assumptions, it estimates the differential more efficiently than the binary split of the same information. Reporting the two together lets the binary specification serve as the readily interpretable anchor, an inelastic-versus-elastic contrast, while the continuous specification shows whether the same pattern holds once the coarse split is relaxed. They are two complementary specifications of a single mechanism, not a headline result and its robustness check.

Five robustness checks probe the durability of the baseline. **(R1) Vienna excluded.**

The model is re-estimated on the sample excluding the Viennese districts, since all of Vienna falls into the inelastic group and its apartment-dominated markets are structurally distinctive, so this check confirms that the differential is not driven by Vienna alone. **(R2) Pre-tail sample.** The model is re-estimated on the sample that excludes the constructed tail of the control series, where income is extrapolated and unemployment and population are carried forward, as documented in Section 4.4, to confirm that the imputed observations do not drive the findings. **(R3) Alternative shock instruments.** The twenty-year and thirty-year German government bond yield surprises are used in place of the OIS 20Y instrument, which checks that the result does not hinge on the particular measure of the shock. **(R4) Alternative classification threshold.** The building-land threshold that separates elastic from inelastic districts is varied, which complements the continuous-measure specification in guarding against an arbitrary cut-off. **(R5) Lag-augmented inference.** The lag-augmentation approach of Montiel Olea and Plagborg-Møller (2021), described in Section 5.6, is applied as a check on the Driscoll-Kraay standard errors that carry the reported inference, since its validity does not rely on the growing time dimension that the primary estimator assumes. This guards against the small-sample weakness of the primary estimator at the length of the panel, rather than making significance conditional on the agreement of several corrections.

6. Empirical Results

This chapter reports the estimated differential response of district real estate prices to ECB monetary policy surprises. It proceeds from the baseline specification, presented together with the continuous supply measure specification, to the alternative specifications that characterize the response, and concludes with the robustness checks that examine its durability. The discussion here is confined to the empirical results of the estimates, their sign, magnitude, precision, and shape across the horizon. The economic interpretation of results is taken up in Section 7.

Two conventions govern how the estimates are reported throughout. The first concerns the scale of the shock. A raw coefficient (β_h) is the response to a one-unit monetary surprise, that is, a monetary surprise of one basis point. The coefficients are therefore re-scaled, and are read as the response to a shock of one standard deviation of the net

quarterly surprise, measured across the 36 quarters, and stated in percent. The shock is a signed net surprise, negative in easing quarters and positive in tightening quarters. The baseline coefficient measures a symmetric response to a movement in this signed measure. The reported response evaluates this coefficient at a one-standard-deviation easing surprise, that is, it multiplies β_h by the negative of one standard deviation. This makes the sign read intuitively. Under the convention of Section 5.4 the raw coefficient is expected to be negative when the mechanism holds. Multiplying a negative coefficient by a negative easing surprise yields a positive number, so throughout this chapter a positive value denotes a larger price increase in supply-inelastic districts following monetary easing. The separation of easing from tightening surprises is a feature only of the asymmetric specification in Section 6.2. Elsewhere the response is symmetric and the easing framing is a reporting device, not a restriction of the model. In these symmetric specifications a tightening surprise of the same size is estimated to have an equal and opposite effect by construction, so a reported easing response of a given sign implies a tightening response of the same magnitude and the opposite sign.

The second convention concerns the specifications where the supply measure enters continuously. Here, the building land reserve enters in standardized form. The raw building land reserve is demeaned and divided by its standard deviation across the 116 districts, and oriented so that a higher value denotes a more supply-constrained district. Its coefficient is therefore the differential response per one standard deviation of the reserve, whereas the binary coefficient is a difference between two supply-groups of districts. The two are not comparable in magnitude and are compared instead on the sign, shape, and precision of the estimated response.

6.1. Baseline Results

The baseline estimates the differential response of the composite price ($p_{i,t}^{\text{comp}}$) using the binary inelastic classification. The estimated response, shown in the left panel of Figure 9, is small and imprecisely estimated at every horizon. It begins slightly negative at the horizons immediately following the monetary surprise, turns positive from around three quarters ahead, and builds to a peak of about 0.25% near horizon seven before receding over the remainder of the three-year window. The confidence interval, formed from the Driscoll-Kraay standard errors, contains zero at every horizon, so the differential

cannot be distinguished from zero at conventional levels. The point estimates in Table 1 convey the same picture at the tabulated horizons, with the response reaching about 0.14% at horizon ten against a standard error of similar magnitude.

Although the differential is not statistically distinguishable from zero, two features of the point estimates are worth recording. From horizon three onward, the sign is in line with the hypothesized supply mechanism, showing a stronger price response where construction is more constrained. The profile is a delayed, hump shape rather than an immediate jump, in line with the price momentum documented in Section 4.1. The peak differential of about 0.25% is also small relative to the roughly 1.3% average quarterly composite price growth over the sample, so that the supply channel, if present at the estimated magnitude, would add only modestly to the price dynamics that districts experience in any case.

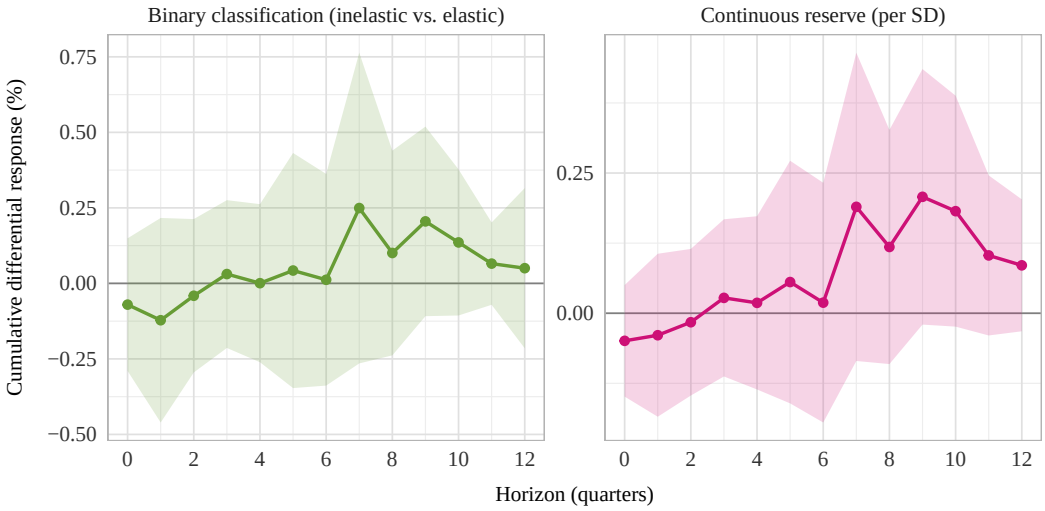


Figure 9: Differential price response, binary and continuous supply measures
Cumulative differential response of the composite price to a one-standard-deviation easing surprise, in %. Left: binary inelastic classification; right: continuous building land reserve (per standard deviation). Shaded bands are 95% Driscoll-Kraay confidence intervals. The two panels use different units and are compared on shape and precision, not level.

The continuous specification (**AS3**), shown in the right panel of Figure 9, traces a similar profile. Its response is slightly negative at the first horizons, positive from around three quarters ahead, and rising to a peak between horizons seven and nine before receding.

What distinguishes it from the binary specification is its precision, not its shape. The standard errors are roughly half as wide at most horizons, as the columns of Table 1 show, so that the confidence interval narrows around the same path. At the longer horizons the lower bound of the interval approaches zero without crossing it, so that the differential comes close to being distinguishable from zero. This is the pattern the argument in Section 5.7 anticipated, since retaining the full gradient of supply conditions rather than a binary split uses the cross-sectional variation more efficiently and sharpens the estimate of the same underlying response. Read together, the two specifications describe a delayed, positively signed differential of modest size, estimated imprecisely under the binary split and more sharply, though still short of conventional significance, when supply conditions enter continuously. The raw coefficients at every horizon are reported in Appendix Table A.5.

	Binary classification			Continuous reserve		
Horizon h	Estimate	SE	95% CI	Estimate	SE	95% CI
0	-0.070	0.112	[-0.290, 0.149]	-0.049	0.051	[-0.149, 0.050]
2	-0.041	0.130	[-0.295, 0.213]	-0.016	0.067	[-0.147, 0.115]
4	0.001	0.133	[-0.261, 0.262]	0.018	0.079	[-0.136, 0.173]
6	0.012	0.179	[-0.338, 0.362]	0.019	0.109	[-0.195, 0.233]
8	0.101	0.173	[-0.238, 0.440]	0.118	0.107	[-0.091, 0.327]
10	0.136	0.123	[-0.106, 0.377]	0.182	0.105	[-0.024, 0.388]
12	0.050	0.135	[-0.215, 0.315]	0.085	0.060	[-0.032, 0.203]

Note. Estimates are the cumulative differential response of the composite price to a one-standard-deviation easing surprise, in %, with Driscoll-Kraay standard errors and 95% confidence intervals. The binary coefficient is a difference between supply-inelastic and supply-elastic districts; the continuous coefficient is per standard deviation of the building land reserve, and the two are not comparable in magnitude.

Table 1: Baseline differential response, binary and continuous supply measures
Response to a one-standard-deviation easing surprise, in %, at selected horizons.

6.2. Alternative Specifications

The alternative specifications characterize the response rather than test its durability, and each is reported on the same per-standard-deviation easing scale introduced at the start of this chapter.

(AS2) Asymmetric shock decomposition. The net shock is split within each quarter into an easing component, the sum of the negative surprises, and a tightening component, the sum of the positive surprises, and the two enter the model with separate interactions. This addresses whether the transmission of monetary policy is asymmetric between easing and tightening surprises. Figure 10 reports the decomposition under the binary classification. The easing response traces a delayed, positively signed profile that peaks at about 0.28% near horizon seven, close in shape to the baseline, while the tightening response is flatter and less regular around zero. Neither is statistically distinguishable from zero at any horizon under the binary split, so the two responses cannot be distinguished from one another on the basis of these estimates alone, though the point estimates suggest that the easing side is where the differential builds.



Figure 10: Asymmetric differential response, binary supply measure
Cumulative differential response to a one-standard-deviation easing (left) and tightening (right) surprise, in %, by horizon in quarters, under the binary inelastic classification. Shaded bands are 95% Driscoll-Kraay confidence intervals.

The continuous supply-measure sharpens this picture. Estimating the same decomposition with the building land reserve entered continuously, on the same per-standard-deviation-of-reserve scale as in the baseline, Figure 11 shows an easing response that is distinguishable from zero at the longer horizons, with a differential of about 0.23% at horizon nine (confidence interval $[0.01, 0.46]$), 0.16% at horizon 11 (confidence interval $[0.02, 0.30]$), and about 0.14% at horizon twelve (confidence interval $[0.01, 0.27]$), where

the interval excludes zero. The tightening response remains centered on zero throughout, with intervals that always contain zero. The easing differential is therefore distinguishable from zero at these horizons while the tightening differential is not, a pattern that is consistent with an asymmetry in which the amplification of the price response in supply-constrained districts operates through monetary easing rather than through tightening. The difference between the two responses is not itself formally tested, so the asymmetry is read as suggestive rather than established. What the estimates show directly is that only the easing side attains a differential distinguishable from zero. This is nonetheless the sharpest evidence in the analysis for the hypothesized channel, and its placement at the longer horizons is consistent with the delayed build seen in the level response. It should be read under the stipulation that these are the horizons at which the estimation sample is smallest and the Driscoll-Kraay lag longest, so the precision is most fragile precisely where the differential clears zero. The raw easing and tightening coefficients for both the binary and the continuous decomposition are reported in Appendix Tables A.6 and A.7.



Figure 11: Asymmetric differential response, continuous supply measure
Cumulative differential response per standard deviation of the building land reserve to a one-standard-deviation easing (left) and tightening (right) surprise, in %, by horizon in quarters. Shaded bands are 95% Driscoll-Kraay confidence intervals.

(AS1) Property-specific outcomes. Estimating the house and apartment series as separate outcomes probes whether the composite result reflects a common response

of both segments or is driven by one of them. In its unweighted form, however, this split is uninformative by construction, since it estimates each segment's response with equal weight across all districts. Given the heterogeneity of the district housing stock documented in Section 4.1, where many districts are almost entirely houses or almost entirely apartments, each segment regression is then dominated in part by districts where that segment is a negligible share of the local market and its measured price is thin and noisy. The resulting estimates, reported in Appendix A.1, are correspondingly imprecise, with wide intervals and no clear or interpretable profile in either series, and are best read as a motivation for the weighted specification rather than as a result in their own right.

(AS1b) Stock-weighted property-specific outcomes. The weighted specification described in Section 5.7 addresses this by weighting each district-quarter by the fixed stock share of the segment being modeled, so that a district contributes to a segment in proportion to how material that segment is to its local market and thinly represented segments add little noise. This sharpens the property-specific estimates considerably. Figure 12 reports the result, on the continuous building land reserve scale, with the raw coefficients at every horizon in Appendix Table A.8. The house response is imprecise throughout but turns mildly positive at the longer horizons, in the direction the mechanism predicts and in contrast to the unweighted split. The apartment response is more pronounced and is distinguishable from zero at horizon six, where the differential is about -0.39% (confidence interval $[-0.62, -0.16]$), before returning toward zero. The negative sign indicates that apartment prices in supply-constrained districts respond less strongly, or in the opposite direction, to easing at this horizon than in less constrained districts, a pattern that runs counter to the house segment and to the composite. The weighted apartment response is estimated predominantly on the urban, apartment-heavy districts, which are also those classified as inelastic and geographically concentrated, as documented in Section 4.3. This segment-level result is therefore bound up with that concentration, whose interpretation is taken up in Section 7.

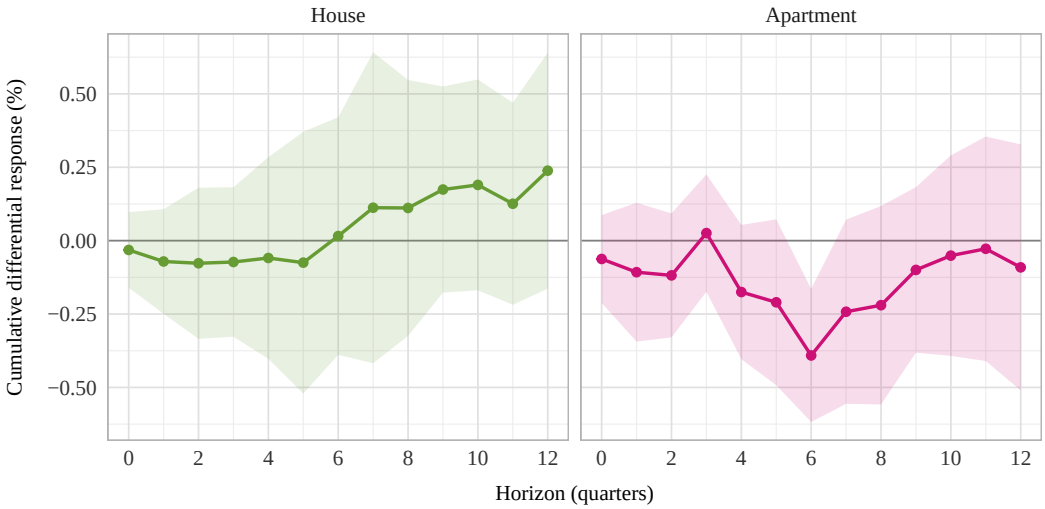


Figure 12: Stock-weighted property-specific differential response
Cumulative differential response of the house (left) and apartment (right) price per standard deviation of the building land reserve to a one-standard-deviation easing surprise, in % , by horizon in quarters. Each segment is estimated by weighted least squares, weighting district-quarters by that segment's fixed stock share. Shaded bands are 95% Driscoll-Kraay confidence intervals.

6.3. Robustness Checks

Before probing the durability of the findings, the residual diagnostics confirm that the inference underlying the preceding results is appropriate. Estimated on the baseline specification, the within-district first-order autocorrelation of the residuals, the correlation between a district's residual in one quarter and its residual in the next, rises from near zero at horizon zero to about 0.85 at the longest horizon, as the cumulative outcomes at successive horizons come to overlap over increasingly many quarters. The cross-sectional dependence is present as well, with the mean absolute pairwise correlation of the residuals across districts within a quarter rising to about 0.43 at the longest horizon. Both patterns, reported in Appendix A.4, confirm the dependence anticipated in Section 5.6 and the need for a correction that addresses both of its dimensions, as the Driscoll-Kraay standard errors used throughout do.

The robustness checks then vary an estimation or sample choice while leaving the effect of interest unchanged, in order to establish that the baseline pattern is not an artifact of a particular decision. Figure 13 overlays the baseline response with the two checks

that bear most directly on the concerns raised in Section 4, the exclusion of Vienna and the use of an alternative shock instrument. The profiles track one another closely through the middle horizons, so the delayed, positively signed shape of the response does not depend on the OIS 20Y instrument or on the presence of Vienna in the sample. The one visible divergence is at the longer horizons, where the Vienna-excluded path flattens and turns slightly negative while the others remain positive, indicating that the magnitude of the differential beyond the two-year horizon is carried disproportionately by the Viennese districts.

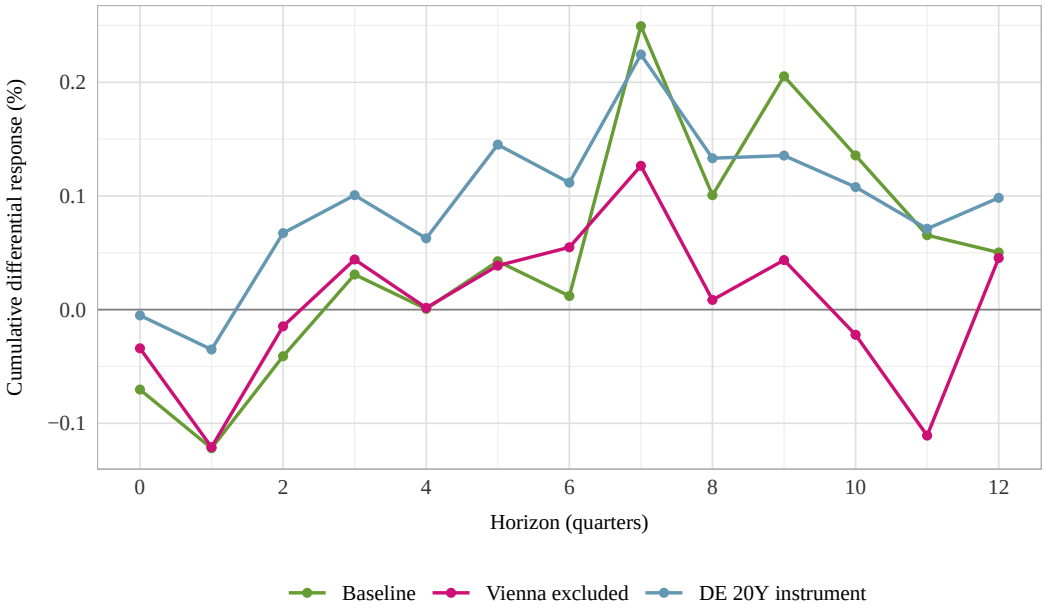


Figure 13: Robustness of the differential response
Cumulative differential response to a one-standard-deviation easing surprise, in %, by horizon in quarters, for the baseline and two robustness checks. Point estimates only; confidence intervals are omitted for legibility and are reported at focal horizons in Table 2.

Table 2 reports the estimate and confidence interval for every check at the peak horizon, seven quarters ahead, and at the end of the window, twelve quarters ahead. Three patterns are worth noting. First, the peak estimate is stable across the instrument and the classification threshold, ranging from about 0.21% to 0.32% under the German bond instruments and the alternative percentile cut-offs, close to the baseline value of about 0.25%. Second, two checks move the estimate as the data chapter anticipated.

Excluding Vienna roughly halves the peak differential, to about 0.13%, and estimating on the pre-tail sample that drops the extrapolated control observations turns the peak slightly negative, which confirms that the constructed tail contributes to the short-run estimate and motivates its treatment as a sensitivity check. Third, the confidence intervals continue to contain zero at both horizons for every check, with one exception, the lag-augmented estimator, whose heteroskedasticity-robust interval excludes zero at the peak horizon (about 0.25% with interval $[0.01, 0.49]$). Since the lag-augmented estimator shares the baseline point estimate and differs only in the standard error, this indicates that the baseline differential at the peak is distinguishable from zero under an inference procedure whose validity does not rest on the growing time dimension that the Driscoll-Kraay correction assumes, which is reassuring given the short panel, though it remains a single horizon under a single estimator and is not treated as decisive on its own.

	Horizon $h = 7$		Horizon $h = 12$	
Specification	Estimate	95% CI	Estimate	95% CI
Baseline	0.249	[-0.265, 0.764]	0.050	[-0.215, 0.315]
Continuous reserve	0.190	[-0.085, 0.465]	0.085	[-0.032, 0.203]
Vienna excluded	0.127	[-0.430, 0.684]	0.045	[-0.381, 0.472]
Pre-tail sample	-0.027	[-0.490, 0.436]	0.050	[-0.215, 0.315]
DE 20Y instrument	0.224	[-0.032, 0.481]	0.098	[-0.131, 0.328]
DE 30Y instrument	0.212	[-0.099, 0.523]	0.052	[-0.179, 0.283]
Threshold: 20th pct	0.291	[-0.151, 0.732]	0.050	[-0.165, 0.266]
Threshold: 30th pct	0.323	[-0.203, 0.849]	0.146	[-0.165, 0.456]
Lag-augmented	0.249	[0.014, 0.485]	0.050	[-0.270, 0.371]

Note. Each row is a separate estimation. The baseline and the robustness checks use the binary supply classification; the continuous reserve row is included as reference. Intervals are 95% Driscoll-Kraay confidence intervals, except the lag-augmented row, which reports heteroskedasticity-robust intervals following Montiel Olea & Plagborg-Møller (2021).

Table 2: Differential response across robustness checks at focal horizons
Response to a one-standard-deviation easing surprise, in percent, at horizons seven and twelve.

7. Discussion

This chapter interprets the empirical results in light of the hypotheses and the literature reviewed in Section 3. It first evaluates the three hypotheses and answers the research questions, then examines how the entanglement of supply constraints with urbanity and property composition shapes the estimates, and considers the sources of their imprecision. It concludes with the implications of the findings and the limitations of the analysis. Throughout the chapter, a differential response is described as distinguishable from zero only where its 95% confidence interval excludes zero. Patterns in the point estimates that do not meet this criterion are described as consistent with the hypothesized mechanism, but they are not treated as evidence for it.

7.1. Evaluation of the Hypotheses

The evaluation of the individual hypotheses requires the overall pattern of statistical evidence to be addressed first. Across the specifications presented in Section 6 and all 13 horizons, 221 differential coefficients are estimated, and the confidence interval excludes zero for five of them. These are the easing component of the continuous asymmetric specification at horizons nine, 11, and 12 (**AS2**), the stock-weighted apartment response at horizon six (**AS1b**), and the lag-augmented baseline estimate at horizon seven (**R5**). Under the null hypothesis of no differential response, a test at the 5% level rejects in about 5% of cases by construction. Five rejections among 221 estimates therefore do not in themselves constitute statistical evidence of a differential response. Moreover, the cumulative outcomes at adjacent horizons share all but one quarter of their accumulation window, so that a sequence of neighboring horizons excluding zero amounts to less than several independent findings. The evaluation below therefore rests on the consistency of sign and shape across specifications as much as on individual intervals.

Hypothesis 1, which addresses Sub-question 1, predicts a stronger price response to easing surprises in supply-inelastic districts (Aastveit & Anundsen, 2022; Saiz, 2010). The results reported in Section 6.1 do not support it at conventional levels. What they show is a differential whose sign and delayed profile match the mechanism documented for United States metropolitan areas (Aastveit & Anundsen, 2022), and whose point estimate at the peak changes little across the alternative instruments and classification

thresholds. Two further findings qualify this result. The differential is modest relative to the average growth of composite prices, and the stock-weighted apartment response is negative in the segment that dominates the most constrained districts, which runs counter to the hypothesis. Hypothesis 1 is therefore not confirmed.

Hypothesis 2, which addresses Sub-question 2, predicts that the differential holds over the three-year window, since a durable housing stock cannot quickly erode a price gap once it has opened (Glaeser & Gyourko, 2005). The symmetric responses instead build gradually and recede after their peak. The gradual build is consistent with the price momentum documented in Section 4.1 (Case & Shiller, 1988; Guren, 2018), but the subsequent decline is not what persistence would imply. In the later part of the window, the only intervals that exclude zero are those of the easing component under the continuous measure at horizons nine, 11, and 12, which are subject to the multiple-testing consideration discussed above. These horizons also rest on the smallest estimation samples, as the regression at horizon 12 draws on only the 19 base quarters from Q2 2018 to Q4 2022. Since the design does not test whether the late response differs from the peak, Hypothesis 2 cannot be confirmed.

Hypothesis 3, which addresses Sub-question 3, predicts that the amplification is concentrated in easing surprises (Aastveit & Anundsen, 2022; Glaeser & Gyourko, 2005). It is the only hypothesis for which intervals exclude zero in the predicted direction at more than one horizon. Under the continuous supply measure, the easing component excludes zero at three of the 13 horizons, while the tightening component does so at none. The support nonetheless remains limited, as the intervals clear zero by a narrow margin and the difference between the two components is not tested. The pattern does not arise mechanically from the shrinking long-horizon sample, which at horizon 12 retains about 59% of the total magnitude of tightening surprises but only about 43% of that of easing surprises. Because the decomposition follows the sign of each surprise rather than the policy stance, the largest easing surprises of the sample fall into the tightening cycle of 2022 and 2023. A tightening response centered on zero is closer to the finding of Aastveit and Anundsen (2022) than to that of Albuquerque (2024), although an interval that contains zero does not show that the tightening response is independent of supply conditions. Hypothesis 3 is therefore suggested by the estimates, but not established.

Taken together, the results allow only a cautious answer to the primary research question. Local supply constraints moderate the response of district-level real estate prices to ECB

monetary policy surprises at most modestly. The sign and shape of the differential are consistent with the supply mechanism, and the long-horizon response to easing surprises under the continuous measure is the only pattern for which intervals exclude zero at more than one horizon, although these horizons lie close together and are therefore not independent. The evidence does not establish that supply-constrained districts respond more strongly, and much of the long-horizon differential rests on the Viennese districts, which differ from the remaining inelastic districts in more than their supply conditions.

7.2. Supply Constraints, Urbanity, and Property Composition

The supply classification reflects districts that differ not only in the availability of building land. Table 3 divides the 47 inelastic districts into the 23 Viennese municipal districts, nine statutory cities, and 15 further districts, most of them Alpine, tourism-oriented, or suburban, and compares them to the elastic districts (see Appendix Table A.3 for the full classification). The Viennese districts consist almost entirely of apartments, and the statutory cities are predominantly apartment markets as well, whereas the remaining inelastic districts are closer to the elastic districts in their property mix but operate at a considerably higher price level. The classification therefore combines scarcity that results from the extensive development of urban land with scarcity that results from terrain, consistent with Saiz (2010), who shows that supply elasticity reflects both geographic and regulatory constraints. The latter group corresponds to the Alpine and tourism districts described in Section 2.4 (Reiner & Musil, 2023; Schindelegger & Seher, 2025). Vienna also differs in its tenure structure. In 2020, social housing accounted for about 43% of the Viennese housing stock, divided almost equally between council housing and limited-profit housing, while homeownership accounted for about 20% (Kadi & Lilius, 2022), in line with the low owner-occupancy rate documented in Section 4.4.

Group	Districts	Building land reserve (%)	House weight	Composite price (€/m²)
Vienna municipal districts	23	4.5	0.07	5 095
Inelastic statutory cities	9	14.6	0.23	3 320
Other inelastic districts	15	20.2	0.53	4 024
Elastic districts	69	27.9	0.67	2 475

Note. Unweighted means across districts. Statutory cities are the inelastic districts outside Vienna with the status of a statutory city (Statutarstadt). The building land reserve refers to 2014, the house weight to the 2011 dwelling stock, and the composite price is each district's mean over Q1 2017 to Q4 2025.

Table 3: Characteristics of supply-inelastic and supply-elastic districts

The estimates for Vienna and for the apartment segment do not add up to a consistent picture. Excluding Vienna roughly halves the peak of the composite differential and turns its long-horizon path slightly negative, so that the positive differential beyond two years rests largely on the Viennese districts (see Section 6.3). The stock-weighted apartment response, which is estimated predominantly on these districts, is instead negative and excludes zero at horizon six. The first result is in line with the argument of Section 4.4 that the apartment-heavy and investor-oriented composition of inelastic districts reinforces the supply mechanism (Biljanovska et al., 2025), whereas the second runs against it. Since the two results differ in horizon and in the measure of supply constraints, they do not describe a single Viennese response. The literature, moreover, points to channels in both directions. Battistini et al. (2025) find that monetary policy has a larger effect on house prices in euro area regions with higher homeownership rates, which they attribute to housing wealth and collateral effects. By that reasoning, the low homeownership rate in Vienna would dampen rather than amplify the price response, although Austria is not part of their sample and the comparison therefore holds only by analogy. The investor channel, in turn, is present in Vienna but limited in scale, as institutional investors hold between about 3% and 11% of the city's housing units depending on the definition of ownership, concentrated in newly built private rental housing (Kadi et al., 2025).

Several readings of the apartment result are possible, and none can be established within the present design. The most cautious reading is that it is an isolated estimate, since it excludes zero at a single horizon of one specification and returns toward zero thereafter.

A second reading concerns the comparison the weighted regression makes. Because the weights concentrate the apartment regression on apartment-heavy districts, its variation in the reserve largely contrasts Vienna with the statutory cities, so the result may reflect differences between Vienna and cities such as Graz, Linz, or Salzburg rather than land scarcity as such. Third, the outcome is an average transaction price per m^2 rather than a quality-adjusted index, so that shifts in the composition of transacted apartments can move the measured price independently of market conditions (Mundt & Wagner, 2017; Spiegel, 2025). Finally, the rental institutions of Vienna may narrow the segment of the market in which prices adjust to financing conditions. At least 78% of the private rental stock is rent-controlled, so that only about 7.6% of all dwellings are let at free-market rents, and a higher share of limited-profit housing is associated with lower private rent trajectories (Banabak, 2022). This channel does not, however, clearly distinguish Vienna from the statutory cities, as social housing accounts for about 32% of the stock in the other Austrian cities with more than 100 000 inhabitants and for more than half in Linz (Kadi & Lilius, 2022), and the evidence concerns rents rather than the response of purchase prices to monetary policy.

These considerations bear directly on assumption (A2) of Section 5.6. The characteristics that move with the supply classification, namely urbanity, tenure structure, investor presence, property composition, and region, are the kind of district traits that could shape the response to a common shock independently of land scarcity. The regional dimension is particularly pronounced, since all districts of Salzburg and none of Burgenland are classified as inelastic, and the specification does not include Bundesland-by-quarter effects that would absorb regional developments. A specification that interacts both the reserve and the house weight with the shock would not resolve this, because the two measures correlate at about 0.91, so that their separate coefficients could not be estimated with useful precision. The possibility of such confounding therefore cannot be excluded. The estimated differential is best read as the response of land-scarce, urban or Alpine, apartment-heavy, and largely rental markets relative to the remaining districts, in which land scarcity is one component rather than a separately identified effect.

7.3. Sources of Imprecision

The imprecision of the estimates has several sources, which concern how sharply the differential can be measured rather than whether it exists. Because the quarter fixed effects absorb everything common to all districts within a quarter, the analysis identifies only the differential response between supply groups, not the aggregate response of Austrian house prices to monetary policy. A small or imprecisely estimated differential therefore carries no implication for the magnitude of the aggregate effect, which this design is not constructed to measure.

The first source of imprecision is the limited variation available for identification. The panel contains 116 districts, of which 47 are classified as inelastic, but the 23 Viennese districts form a single urban market, so the number of independent supply-constrained units is smaller than the count suggests. The time dimension is short at 36 quarters, and it shrinks with the horizon, as the regression at horizon 12 rests on 19 base quarters. The residuals are also dependent in both dimensions, with the within-district serial correlation rising to about 0.85 and the cross-sectional correlation to about 0.43 at the longest horizon, so that neighboring observations carry less independent information than their number implies. These features widen the confidence intervals, and the Driscoll-Kraay correction that produces them relies on a time dimension that is itself short, a concern the lag-augmented estimator addresses only at a single horizon (Driscoll & Kraay, 1998; Montiel Olea & Plagborg-Møller, 2021). Measurement adds a second source. The monetary surprise is small in scale, with a standard deviation of about 2.66 basis points, and the signed components partly cancel within quarters, so that the identifying variation is modest. The supply classification is a single predetermined stock, the share of vacant building land, which stands in for the responsiveness of local supply rather than measuring it directly, and the reserve records land that is zoned but not necessarily available for construction, since zoning carries no obligation to build (Schindelegger & Seher, 2025). Measurement error of this kind in the moderator tends to attenuate the interaction toward zero, which works against detecting a differential. Finally, the outcome is an average transaction price per m^2 rather than a quality-adjusted index, so that changes in the composition of transacted dwellings enter the measured price as noise (Mundt & Wagner, 2017; Spiegel, 2025).

Features of the Austrian housing market may also dampen the differential itself. The

transmission of a policy rate change to borrowers depends on the period over which the loan rate is fixed, and the fixation structure of Austrian lending shifted substantially over the sample, as documented in Section 2.3. How exposed a district is to a rate change thus depends on the mix of older variable-rate and more recent fixed-rate loans in its outstanding stock, and this mix is not observed at the district level, so the heterogeneity cannot be exploited in the analysis. The tenure and regulatory structure examined in Section 7.2 points in the same direction, since a large regulated rental sector narrows the segment of the market in which prices adjust to financing conditions. The wealth channel through which house-price movements feed back to the Austrian economy is in any case estimated to be present but small (Albacete & Lindner, 2017).

A comparison with the United States evidence places the estimated magnitudes in perspective. Aastveit and Anundsen (2022) report that an easing of one percentage point in the policy rate raises real house prices by close to 7% after two years in the most supply-inelastic metropolitan areas, against below 3% where supply is elastic. The differentials estimated here are of the order of a few tenths of a percent. The two sets of figures are not directly comparable, since they are expressed in different units, a one percentage point change in the policy rate in the first case and a one standard deviation surprise in the 20-year OIS rate, of about 2.66 basis points, in the second, and no straightforward rescaling connects them. The comparison is therefore informative only for the sign and the shape of the response, not for its level. The same caution applies to the euro area evidence of Battistini et al. (2025), which draws on the same high-frequency database as this thesis but within a structural panel vector autoregression rather than a local projection, so that the estimated magnitudes again answer a different question.

7.4. Implications

The implications of these findings are necessarily tentative, since the central estimates are not distinguishable from zero. For monetary policy, the analysis provides no evidence that the scarcity of developable land turned ECB policy into a major driver of regional divergence in Austrian house prices over the sample period, while the limited precision discussed above means that a moderate differential of this kind cannot be excluded. This statement concerns the differential response across supply groups and not the aggregate effect of monetary policy on Austrian house prices, which the design does not measure.

In any case, the ECB conducts a single policy for the euro area as a whole and cannot respond to conditions in individual districts, so that whatever regional unevenness arises in the transmission of its policy is a matter for national and regional actors rather than for the central bank. The contribution of a district-level analysis is accordingly to show how a common monetary impulse is distributed across regional housing markets, consistent with the heterogeneity in euro area transmission documented by Battistini et al. (2025), rather than to identify a lever that monetary policy could use.

Where the local housing stock can expand, the scope for that expansion is governed by land and planning policy rather than by monetary policy. The literature reviewed in Section 2 indicates that housing affordability in Austria is a structural condition rather than a by-product of any single phase of monetary policy (Matějková & Tichá, 2025; Mundt et al., 2024), and that the more effective response to it lies in enlarging the supply of housing rather than in demand-side subsidies (Mundt et al., 2024). Since the allocation and mobilization of building land rest largely with the municipalities, and since land that is zoned is not necessarily brought to development (Schindelegger & Seher, 2025), the responsiveness of local supply is itself a policy variable. To the extent that the suggestive long-horizon response to easing surprises in supply-constrained districts reflects the mechanism this thesis examines, it is in these districts that the availability of developable land shapes whether a demand impulse raises prices or calls forth new construction.

Credit conditions carry a related implication for macroprudential policy. The exposure of households to changes in financing costs depends on the structure of their mortgages, which shifted over the sample toward longer rate fixation, as documented in Section 2.3. Austria introduced borrower-based lending standards for residential real estate financing in 2022, in the form of the KIM-VO, which sets limits on the loan-to-value ratio, the debt-service-to-income ratio, and the loan maturity (Österreichische Finanzmarktaufsicht (FMA), 2022), within the same tightening phase in which housing loan growth receded. If the amplified response to easing surprises in supply-constrained districts is genuine, it is in these markets that the build-up of price pressure during periods of easing is most likely to warrant such attention, consistent with the concerns about overvaluation and the financial-stability risks of unconventional policy raised in the literature (Berg et al., 2024; Biljanovska et al., 2025). The analysis here does not evaluate these measures, and the connection is drawn as context rather than as a result.

7.5. Limitations

The most important limitation concerns the interpretation of the estimated coefficient. The identification rests on three assumptions set out in Section 5.6. The exogeneity of the monetary surprise (A1) is supported by the high-frequency identification, which isolates the component of policy unanticipated by markets, and any aggregate information content is absorbed by the quarter fixed effects (Altavilla et al., 2019; Jarociński & Karadi, 2020); what remains is the possibility of Austria-specific developments that coincide with the surprises and do not affect all districts equally. The absence of a confounding district characteristic (A2) cannot be secured, as discussed in Section 7.2, since the supply classification is bound up with urbanity, tenure, and property composition. The validity of the supply proxy (A3) is likewise only approximate, since the building land reserve stands in for an elasticity it does not measure directly. Taken together, these assumptions mean that the differential is best read as the response of a distinct group of markets relative to the rest, in which land scarcity is one component, rather than as the isolated causal effect of supply constraints.

A second limitation is the length and character of the observation window. The panel covers 36 quarters, which span a single pronounced upswing and its correction, and the most pronounced movements in Austrian house prices began before the window for which consistent district-level data are available, so that the panel captures only part of the full cycle. The estimation sample also contracts with the horizon, so that the longer-horizon coefficients, including those for which the confidence interval excludes zero, rest on the earliest and smallest part of the sample, with the regression at horizon 12 drawing on 19 base quarters. The period was moreover dominated by unconventional policy and the subsequent tightening, so that the extent to which the results would carry over to a setting of conventional interest rate policy cannot be assessed.

The remaining limitations concern the data, the specification, and the scope of the estimates. The outcome is an average transaction price per m^2 rather than a quality-adjusted index, so that shifts in the composition of transacted dwellings enter the measured price, and several control series are extrapolated at the end of the sample, which the pre-tail sensitivity sample shows to affect the short-run estimates (Mundt & Wagner, 2017; Spiegel, 2025). The composite weights are fixed at their 2011 values, which keeps them exogenous but does not reflect later changes in property composition. On

the specification, the panel is not large enough along the cross-sectional dimension to add Bundesland-by-quarter fixed effects, so that regional developments correlated with the supply classification are not absorbed, and the design does not formally test the persistence or the asymmetry of the response, both of which are therefore read from the profile of the estimates. The small number of horizons at which the confidence interval excludes zero, five of the 221 estimated coefficients, must be weighed against the number of estimates, as noted in Section 7.1. Finally, the shock combines the conventional and the unconventional components of monetary policy within a single long-maturity surprise, and the results pertain to Austrian districts with their particular institutional features, so that the external validity of the estimates beyond this setting remains to be established.

8. Conclusion

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A. Appendix

Variable	N	Mean	SD	Min	Median	Max
Outcome						
Composite price (€/m^2)	4 176	3 261	1 593	868	2 876	13 500
House price (€/m^2)	4 176	4 203	2 699	849	3 200	16 212
Apartment price (€/m^2)	4 176	2 865	1 539	742	2 471	13 515
Composite price growth (log change)	4 060	0.0135	0.0238	-0.1080	0.0118	0.1570
Monetary policy shock						
Net shock (OIS 20Y)	36	-0.59	2.66	-5.10	-1.20	5.40
Easing component	36	-2.29	2.30	-9.70	-1.90	0.00
Tightening component	36	1.70	2.06	0.00	0.72	8.50
Supply measure						
Building land reserve (%)	116	21.2	10.2	0.1	23.8	45.5
House weight	116	0.500	0.273	0.003	0.580	0.874
Controls						
Population	4 176	77 446	47 622	1 900	65 370	305 314
Unemployment rate (%)	4 176	6.0	3.3	1.6	5.0	17.9
Net income per capita (€)	4 176	22 680	4 797	5 155	21 680	51 092

Note. N differs by variable block. Prices and controls are observed at the district-quarter level. The monetary policy shock varies only over the 36 quarters. The supply measure and the fixed dwelling-stock weights are time-invariant, they vary over the 116 districts. Composite price growth is a quarterly log change and is undefined in the first quarter of each district, which accounts for its lower count.

Table A.1: Summary statistics of the analysis variables

Diagnostic	Result
Balanced panel (districts × quarters)	116 × 36 = 4 176
Unique district-quarter keys	4 176 (no duplicates)
Missing or unexpected keys	0
Districts observed in all 36 quarters	116
Source inputs joined without key errors	7 of 7
Non-positive or non-finite price cells	0
Weight-sum and composite identity errors	0

Table A.2: Panel construction and integrity diagnostics

Federal state	District	Building land reserve (%)	House weight
Kärnten	Klagenfurt Stadt	18.5	0.27
Niederösterreich	Wiener Neustadt (Stadt)	19.9	0.30
	Mödling	19.9	0.46
	Waidhofen an der Ybbs (Stadt)	21.2	0.54
Oberösterreich	Stadt Linz	8.1	0.11
	Stadt Wels	17.7	0.26
	Stadt Steyr	18.9	0.22
	Rohrbach	20.9	0.79
	Gmunden	21.8	0.57
Salzburg	Salzburg (Stadt)	5.9	0.16
	Salzburg-Umgebung	19.5	0.57
	Hallein	21.2	0.51
	Sankt Johann im Pongau	21.5	0.43
	Tamsweg	21.6	0.69
	Zell am See	22.0	0.50
Steiermark	Graz (Stadt)	12.0	0.16
	Bruck-Mürzzuschlag	18.5	0.48
Tirol	Innsbruck-Stadt	8.8	0.08
	Kitzbühel	16.3	0.50
	Innsbruck-Land	18.7	0.44
	Kufstein	19.3	0.44
	Imst	20.0	0.60
	Schwaz	20.4	0.48
Vorarlberg	Dornbirn	21.4	0.41
Wien	All 23 municipal districts	0.1 - 10.2	0.00 - 0.25

Note. Districts are classified as supply-inelastic if their 2014 building land reserve lies below the 25th percentile of the reserve distribution outside Vienna (∼22%), which is applied to all districts. All 23 Viennese municipal districts are inelastic and are summarized in one row. The remaining 69 districts are classified as elastic. The house weight is the fixed 2011 share of dwellings in buildings with one or two dwellings.

Table A.3: Supply-inelastic districts under the baseline classification

Horizon h	Residual AR(1)	Mean $\lvert\rho\rvert$	Max $\lvert\rho\rvert$
0	-0.01	0.19	0.81
4	0.78	0.30	0.98
8	0.86	0.41	0.99
12	0.85	0.43	0.99

Note. Residuals are from the baseline two-way fixed-effects specification (Equation 5.1), estimated at selected horizons h. Residual AR(1) is the first-order within-district autocorrelation of the residuals; Mean $\lvert\rho\rvert$ and Max $\lvert\rho\rvert$ are the mean and maximum absolute pairwise correlation of the residuals across districts within a quarter. The values rising over horizons reflect the serial and cross-sectional dependence discussed in Section 5.6 and Section 6.3.

Table A.4: Residual dependence of the baseline specification

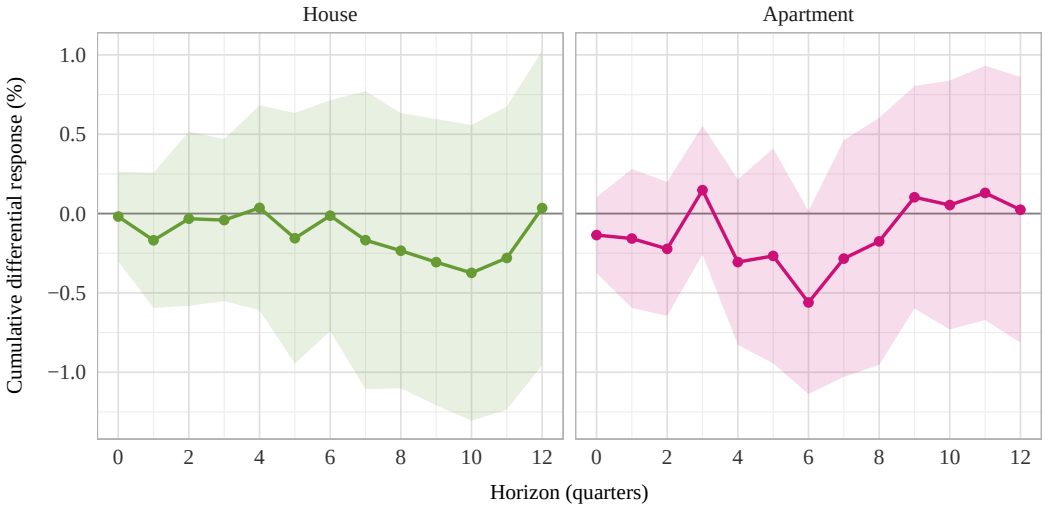


Figure A.1: Property-specific differential response, unweighted
Cumulative differential response of the house (left) and apartment (right) price to a one-standard-deviation easing surprise, in %, by horizon in quarters, under the binary inelastic classification and without stock weighting. Shaded bands are 95% Driscoll-Kraay confidence intervals.

	Binary classification			Continuous reserve			
h	β_h	SE	95% CI	β_h	SE	95% CI	N
0	0.0003	0.0004	[-0.0006, 0.0011]	0.0002	0.0002	[-0.0002, 0.0006]	3596
1	0.0005	0.0007	[-0.0008, 0.0017]	0.0001	0.0003	[-0.0004, 0.0007]	3480
2	0.0002	0.0005	[-0.0008, 0.0011]	0.0001	0.0003	[-0.0004, 0.0006]	3364
3	-0.0001	0.0005	[-0.0010, 0.0008]	-0.0001	0.0003	[-0.0006, 0.0004]	3248
4	-0.0000	0.0005	[-0.0010, 0.0010]	-0.0001	0.0003	[-0.0007, 0.0005]	3132
5	-0.0002	0.0007	[-0.0016, 0.0013]	-0.0002	0.0004	[-0.0010, 0.0006]	3016
6	-0.0000	0.0007	[-0.0014, 0.0013]	-0.0001	0.0004	[-0.0009, 0.0007]	2900
7	-0.0009	0.0010	[-0.0029, 0.0010]	-0.0007	0.0005	[-0.0017, 0.0003]	2784
8	-0.0004	0.0007	[-0.0017, 0.0009]	-0.0004	0.0004	[-0.0012, 0.0003]	2668
9	-0.0008	0.0006	[-0.0020, 0.0004]	-0.0008	0.0004	[-0.0016, 0.0001]	2552
10	-0.0005	0.0005	[-0.0014, 0.0004]	-0.0007	0.0004	[-0.0015, 0.0001]	2436
11	-0.0002	0.0003	[-0.0008, 0.0003]	-0.0004	0.0003	[-0.0009, 0.0001]	2320
12	-0.0002	0.0005	[-0.0012, 0.0008]	-0.0003	0.0002	[-0.0008, 0.0001]	2204

Note. Coefficients per one-basis-point OIS 20Y surprise, with Driscoll-Kraay standard errors and 95% confidence intervals; N: number of district-quarter observations per horizon. Under the sign convention of Section 5.4 a negative coefficient corresponds to a larger price increase in supply-inelastic districts following monetary easing. Percent response to a one-standard-deviation easing surprise reported in the text: $\beta_h \; x \; -SD \; x \; 100$ (SD = 2.66). The continuous coefficient is per one standard deviation of the building land reserve.

Table A.5: Baseline and continuous (AS3) specifications, coefficients
Estimated interaction coefficient per horizon h.

	Easing			Tightening			
h	β_h	SE	95% CI	β_h	SE	95% CI	N
0	0.0005	0.0004	[-0.0003, 0.0014]	-0.0001	0.0005	[-0.0012, 0.0010]	3596
1	0.0007	0.0006	[-0.0006, 0.0020]	0.0001	0.0008	[-0.0015, 0.0017]	3480
2	0.0001	0.0006	[-0.0011, 0.0014]	0.0002	0.0007	[-0.0012, 0.0015]	3364
3	-0.0001	0.0006	[-0.0014, 0.0011]	-0.0001	0.0005	[-0.0010, 0.0008]	3248
4	0.0001	0.0006	[-0.0012, 0.0013]	-0.0001	0.0007	[-0.0016, 0.0014]	3132
5	-0.0001	0.0009	[-0.0019, 0.0017]	-0.0002	0.0008	[-0.0019, 0.0014]	3016
6	-0.0001	0.0008	[-0.0017, 0.0014]	0.0001	0.0008	[-0.0014, 0.0016]	2900
7	-0.0011	0.0010	[-0.0031, 0.0009]	-0.0007	0.0011	[-0.0029, 0.0014]	2784
8	-0.0007	0.0007	[-0.0021, 0.0008]	0.0001	0.0007	[-0.0012, 0.0014]	2668
9	-0.0008	0.0006	[-0.0020, 0.0004]	-0.0007	0.0008	[-0.0022, 0.0008]	2552
10	-0.0003	0.0005	[-0.0013, 0.0006]	-0.0008	0.0007	[-0.0021, 0.0005]	2436
11	-0.0001	0.0003	[-0.0007, 0.0005]	-0.0005	0.0007	[-0.0020, 0.0010]	2320
12	-0.0000	0.0005	[-0.0010, 0.0010]	-0.0004	0.0007	[-0.0018, 0.0010]	2204

Note. Coefficients per one-basis-point OIS 20Y surprise, with Driscoll-Kraay standard errors and 95% confidence intervals; N: number of district-quarter observations at each horizon. The easing and tightening components are the within-quarter sums of the negative and positive surprises. Under the sign convention of Section 5.4 a negative easing coefficient corresponds to a larger price increase in supply-inelastic districts following monetary easing.

Table A.6: Asymmetric specification (AS2), binary classification, coefficients

Estimated easing and tightening interaction coefficients per horizon h.

	Easing			Tightening			
h	β_h	SE	95% CI	β_h	SE	95% CI	N
0	0.0003	0.0002	[-0.0001, 0.0008]	-0.0000	0.0002	[-0.0005, 0.0005]	3596
1	0.0003	0.0003	[-0.0003, 0.0010]	-0.0001	0.0003	[-0.0008, 0.0005]	3480
2	0.0001	0.0004	[-0.0006, 0.0008]	0.0000	0.0004	[-0.0008, 0.0009]	3364
3	-0.0001	0.0004	[-0.0008, 0.0006]	-0.0002	0.0003	[-0.0007, 0.0004]	3248
4	-0.0001	0.0004	[-0.0008, 0.0007]	-0.0001	0.0004	[-0.0009, 0.0008]	3132
5	-0.0002	0.0005	[-0.0013, 0.0008]	-0.0002	0.0005	[-0.0011, 0.0008]	3016
6	-0.0002	0.0005	[-0.0012, 0.0008]	0.0002	0.0005	[-0.0007, 0.0011]	2900
7	-0.0009	0.0006	[-0.0021, 0.0003]	-0.0004	0.0006	[-0.0016, 0.0008]	2784
8	-0.0007	0.0005	[-0.0017, 0.0003]	-0.0001	0.0004	[-0.0008, 0.0007]	2668
9	-0.0009	0.0004	[-0.0017, -0.0000]	-0.0006	0.0005	[-0.0017, 0.0004]	2552
10	-0.0007	0.0004	[-0.0016, 0.0001]	-0.0006	0.0004	[-0.0014, 0.0002]	2436
11	-0.0006	0.0003	[-0.0011, -0.0001]	-0.0000	0.0004	[-0.0008, 0.0007]	2320
12	-0.0005	0.0003	[-0.0010, -0.0000]	-0.0001	0.0003	[-0.0007, 0.0006]	2204

Note. Coefficients per one-basis-point OIS 20Y surprise, interacted with the standardized building land reserve, with Driscoll-Kraay standard errors and 95% confidence intervals; N: number of district-quarter observations at each horizon. Coefficients are per one standard deviation of the reserve. Under the sign convention of Section 5.4 a negative easing coefficient corresponds to a larger price increase in more supply-constrained districts following monetary easing.

Table A.7: Asymmetric specification (AS2), continuous reserve, coefficients

Estimated easing and tightening interaction coefficients per horizon h.

	House			Apartment			
h	β_h	SE	95% CI	β_h	SE	95% CI	N
0	0.0001	0.0002	[-0.0004, 0.0006]	0.0002	0.0003	[-0.0003, 0.0008]	3596
1	0.0003	0.0003	[-0.0004, 0.0009]	0.0004	0.0005	[-0.0005, 0.0013]	3480
2	0.0003	0.0005	[-0.0007, 0.0013]	0.0004	0.0004	[-0.0003, 0.0012]	3364
3	0.0003	0.0005	[-0.0007, 0.0012]	-0.0001	0.0004	[-0.0008, 0.0007]	3248
4	0.0002	0.0007	[-0.0011, 0.0015]	0.0007	0.0004	[-0.0002, 0.0015]	3132
5	0.0003	0.0009	[-0.0014, 0.0020]	0.0008	0.0005	[-0.0003, 0.0019]	3016
6	-0.0001	0.0008	[-0.0016, 0.0015]	0.0015	0.0004	[0.0006, 0.0023]	2900
7	-0.0004	0.0010	[-0.0024, 0.0016]	0.0009	0.0006	[-0.0003, 0.0021]	2784
8	-0.0004	0.0008	[-0.0021, 0.0012]	0.0008	0.0006	[-0.0004, 0.0021]	2668
9	-0.0007	0.0007	[-0.0020, 0.0007]	0.0004	0.0005	[-0.0007, 0.0014]	2552
10	-0.0007	0.0007	[-0.0021, 0.0006]	0.0002	0.0007	[-0.0011, 0.0015]	2436
11	-0.0005	0.0007	[-0.0018, 0.0008]	0.0001	0.0007	[-0.0013, 0.0015]	2320
12	-0.0009	0.0008	[-0.0024, 0.0006]	0.0003	0.0008	[-0.0012, 0.0019]	2204

Note. Coefficients per one-basis-point OIS 20Y surprise, interacted with the standardized building land reserve, with Driscoll-Kraay standard errors and 95% confidence intervals; N: number of district-quarter observations at each horizon. Each segment is estimated by weighted least squares, weighting district-quarters by that segment's fixed stock share. Coefficients are per one standard deviation of the reserve. Under the sign convention of Section 5.4 a negative coefficient corresponds to a larger price increase in more supply-constrained districts following monetary easing.

Table A.8: Stock-weighted property-specific specification (AS1b), coefficients

Estimated interaction coefficient for the house and apartment outcomes per horizon h.